

VARMORA 
TILES • BATHWARE



VARMORA GRANITO LIMITED
(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Our Company was originally incorporated as "Varmora Granito Private Limited" under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956 pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated November 18, 2003, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Gujarat, Dadra and Nagar Haveli. The name of our Company was subsequently changed to "Varmora Granito Limited", upon conversion of our Company from a private limited to a public limited company, pursuant to a board resolution dated April 25, 2025, and a shareholders' resolution dated April 30, 2025. A fresh certificate of incorporation was issued on May 14, 2025, by the Registrar of Companies, Gujarat at Ahmedabad. For details in relation to changes in the name and registered office of our Company, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters – Brief history of our Company" and "History and Certain Corporate Matters – Changes in the registered office" on page 256 of the red herring prospectus dated September 16, 2026 / "RHP" or "Red Herring Prospectus" filed with the RoC.

Registered Office: 8-A, National Highway, Dhuva, Taluka Wankaner, Rajkot - 363 641, Gujarat, India;
Corporate Office: 1004/5/6, South Tower, ONE42, Off. Iscon-Ambli Road, Ahmedabad - 380 054, Gujarat, India. **Telephone:** + 91 - 9909913657
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer: **E-mail:** investor.relations@varmora.com; **Website:** www.varmora.com; **Corporate Identity Number:** U74900GJ2015000000000000

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF VARMORA GRANITO LIMITED ("COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "OFFER") COMPRISING OF A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 3,200.00 MILLION ("FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO 26,217,634 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION BY KATSURA INVESTMENTS (REFERRED TO AS THE "INVESTOR SELLING SHAREHOLDER", AND SUCH EQUITY SHARES OFFERED BY THE INVESTOR SELLING SHAREHOLDER, THE "OFFERED SHARES"). THE OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [●] % OF THE POST-OFFER PAID UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

* As certified by M/s Doshi Doshi & Co, with firm registration number 153683W, pursuant to their certificate dated September 16, 2026.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 70 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 74 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 101 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 2 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 101 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 2 EACH THEREAFTER.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS (P/E RATIO) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 48.52 TIMES
AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 45.90 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 47.12 TIMES.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 6.61%

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹140 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹148 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 2 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 2 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	2,28,57,142	3,200.00	2,16,21,621	3,200.00
Offer for Sale	2,62,17,634	3,670.47	2,62,17,634	3,880.21
Total Offer Size	4,90,74,776	6,870.47	4,78,39,255	7,080.21
Post-Offer market capitalization of the Company	22,72,47,345	31,814.63	22,60,11,824	33,449.75

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON : THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 24, 2026[#]

^aThe UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS. THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARDS OF BSE AND NSE. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE OFFER | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE OFFER

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RHP AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMS").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED SEPTEMBER 16, 2026, THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS DISCLOSED IN THE 'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE' SECTION BEGINNING ON PAGE 134 OF THE RHP V~~IS~~-A-V~~IS~~ THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S), AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN 'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE' SECTION BEGINNING ON PAGE 134 OF THE RHP.

For details refer to section titled "Risk Factors" beginning on page 19 of the RHP

- | <p>1. <u>Significant dependence on in house manufacturing facilities accounting for 81.72% of total revenue from operations in Fiscal 2026:</u> We operate eight in-house manufacturing facilities (through our Company and Subsidiaries). Further, certain of our products are produced at dedicated manufacturing facilities. A significant portion of our revenues are attributable to our in-house manufacturing facilities. The revenue contribution from our in-house manufacturing facilities account for 81.72%, 78.55% and 66.83% in Fiscal 2026, Fiscal 2025 and Fiscal 2024 respectively. Any shutdown or interruption in the operations of any of our existing facilities, or our inability to respond to such shutdown or disruption in a timely manner or at an acceptable cost, could significantly and adversely affect the entire manufacturing of the product specifically produced at such facility.</p> <p>2. <u>Substantial portion of our revenue is derived from the sale of glazed vitrified tiles (“GVT”) and technical products (73.98% of our total revenue from operations in Fiscal 2026):</u> Below are details of our revenues generated from GVT and technical products for the years indicated:</p> | <p>4. <u>Significant portion of our revenue from operations is derived from our B2C retail chain (comprising exclusive brand outlets (“EBOs”) and multi brand outlets (“MBOs”)) (accounting for 66.80% of our total domestic sales in Fiscal 2026):</u> We have an extensive retail distribution network and derive a significant portion of our revenue from operations from our B2C retail chain (comprising EBOs and MBOs) which are operated on a franchisee-owned-franchisee-operated model) and B2B channel comprising partnerships with various architects, builders and contractors and government agencies. As of March 31, 2026, we had a network of 305 EBOs and 2,758 MBOs. Set out below are certain details of our revenues by B2C and B2B channels in India for the years indicated:</p> <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th rowspan="3">Particulars</th><th colspan="6">Fiscal</th></tr> <tr> <th colspan="2">2026</th><th colspan="2">2025</th><th colspan="2">2024</th></tr> <tr> <th>(₹ million)</th><th>% of total</th><th>(₹ million)</th><th>% of total</th><th>(₹ million)</th><th>% of total</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>B2C</td><td>1,000</td><td>66.80%</td><td>950</td><td>66.80%</td><td>900</td><td>66.80%</td></tr> <tr> <td>B2B</td><td>500</td><td>33.20%</td><td>450</td><td>33.20%</td><td>400</td><td>33.20%</td></tr> <tr> <td>Total</td><td>1,500</td><td>100.00%</td><td>1,400</td><td>100.00%</td><td>1,300</td><td>100.00%</td></tr> </tbody> </table> | Particulars | Fiscal | | | | | | 2026 | | 2025 | | 2024 | | (₹ million) | % of total | (₹ million) | % of total | (₹ million) | % of total | B2C | 1,000 | 66.80% | 950 | 66.80% | 900 | 66.80% | B2B | 500 | 33.20% | 450 | 33.20% | 400 | 33.20% | Total | 1,500 | 100.00% | 1,400 | 100.00% | 1,300 | 100.00% |
|--|---|-------------|-------------|------------|-------------|------------|--|--|------|--|------|--|------|--|-------------|------------|-------------|------------|-------------|------------|-----|-------|--------|-----|--------|-----|--------|-----|-----|--------|-----|--------|-----|--------|-------|-------|---------|-------|---------|-------|---------|
| Particulars | Fiscal | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| | 2026 | | 2025 | | 2024 | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| | (₹ million) | % of total | (₹ million) | % of total | (₹ million) | % of total | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| B2C | 1,000 | 66.80% | 950 | 66.80% | 900 | 66.80% | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| B2B | 500 | 33.20% | 450 | 33.20% | 400 | 33.20% | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Total | 1,500 | 100.00% | 1,400 | 100.00% | 1,300 | 100.00% | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

Particulars	Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2024	
	(₹ million)	% of total domestic sales	(₹ million)	% of total domestic sales	(₹ million)	% of total domestic sales
India						
B2B ⁽¹⁾	3,934.47	33.20%	3,519.02	31.18%	2,595.99	24.04%
B2C ⁽²⁾	7,915.59	66.80%	7,767.33	68.82%	8,204.69	75.96%
Total Domestic Sale	11,850.06	100.00%	11,286.35	100.00%	10,800.68	100.00%

Notes:

(1) B2B as a % of total domestic sales represents the Company's revenue attributable to B2B channel (comprising partnerships with various architects, builders and contractors and government agencies) as a percentage of its total sales in India.

⁽²⁾ B2C as a % of total domestic sales represents the Company's revenue attributable to B2C retail channel (through EBOs and MBOs which are operated on a franchisee-owned-franchisee-operated model) as a percentage of its total sales in India.

**Technical products comprise advanced vitrified tile and surface solutions manufactured using combinations of specialized homogeneous body formulations, digital printing on surface engineered through chips, grits and feeder technology such as IST products, which began commercial operations in Fiscal 2026.*

Any negative trend or downturn in the tiles market (particularly GVT) and other markets that we cater to (such as bathware) could result in loss of business or reduction in the volume of business from customers in these industries.

3. **Geographic Concentration risk:** All our revenues are attributable to manufacturing facilities (owned and operated by our Company or Subsidiaries, or third-party contract manufacturers) situated in Morbi, Gujarat, India. Any disruption caused by local and regional factors in the Morbi cluster, could have a significant impact on our business, financial condition, cash flows and operations. In addition, changes in government policies affecting the Morbi region, including any increase in the imposition of tax, tariffs or duties, may require us to change our business strategy. Any such disruption may interrupt the operations at such manufacturing facilities or cause a complete shutdown and affect our ability to provide quality products to our customers in a timely manner.

5. **Risk in relation to conflict of interest:** Our Subsidiaries, Associates and Joint Ventures (some of which are also Group Companies) have common pursuits vis-à-vis our Company and are in a similar line of business as our Company, which may lead to a conflict of interest in the future that in turn may adversely impact our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.
6. **Risks associated with strategic acquisitions and investments:** We have in the past made and may in the future continue to make strategic acquisitions of other companies or businesses with the belief that their resources, capabilities and strategies are complementary, and are likely, to

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enhance our business operations. Acquired businesses or assets may not generate the financial results we expect and may incur losses over time. We acquired a majority stake in Simola in Fiscal 2023; however, the investment did not yield the intended operational and financial benefits, and we subsequently divested our entire partnership interest in Simola on September 5, 2026. Additionally, we intend to leverage our capabilities and focus on brownfield expansion through companies and businesses that offer access to untapped geographies. Any failure to successfully evaluate, execute, integrate or manage acquisitions or investments, or to realize the anticipated synergies, operational efficiencies or strategic benefits from such transactions, may result in additional costs, impairment of investments, diversion of management attention and loss of business opportunities. Such factors could adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows, results of operations and prospects.

- 7. Operations subject to volatility in the supply and pricing of raw materials, packing materials and dependence on supplier:** Our operations are subject to volatility in the supply and pricing of raw materials and packing materials. We are also dependent on our top suppliers for the supply for certain raw materials. Any loss of suppliers or interruptions in the timely delivery of supplies or price escalations could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations. Set out below are details of our top ten suppliers for the years indicated:

Particulars	Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	% of Total expenses	Amount (₹ million)	% of Total expenses	Amount (₹ million)	% of Total expenses
Top ten suppliers*	1203.46	8.10%	1,722.90	11.83%	2,052.86	14.53%

Note:
*The top ten suppliers are the top ten suppliers in terms of total expenses for each of the respective years and may not necessarily be the same suppliers in each year; excludes intercompany transactions (with subsidiaries).

Any loss of suppliers or interruptions in the timely delivery of supplies or price escalations could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

- 8. Portion of our revenue from operations is derived from outside India (revenue from contracts with customers from outside India was 21.11% of our Sale of Products in Fiscal 2026):** Since inception, we exported our products to over 100 countries as of March 31, 2026. We depend on our exports for a significant portion of our revenues which exposes us to risks inherent to operations in these foreign jurisdictions. Our global operations expose us to risks such as compliance with local laws, and any failure to comply with applicable laws or regulations could lead to civil, administrative or regulatory proceedings which could adversely affect our business, results of operations and financial condition. Set out below is the disaggregation of our revenue from contracts with customers by geographical markets for the years indicated:

Particulars	Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2024	
	(₹ million)	% of Sale of Products	(₹ million)	% of Sale of Products	(₹ million)	% of Sale of Products
Geographical markets						
India	11,850.06	78.89%	11,286.35	78.69%	10,800.68	75.99%
Outside India	3,170.92	21.11%	3,056.27	21.31%	3,413.21	24.01%
Sale of Products	15,020.98	100.00%	14,342.62	100.00%	14,213.89	100.00%

- 9. Competition risk:** We operate in highly competitive markets in each of our product categories. We face competition from large, organized and branded players. We also compete with smaller, regional and unbranded players in the market that may have more flexibility in responding to changing business and economic conditions than us. Our inability to compete effectively may adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.
- 10. A portion of our revenue is generated from products manufactured by third-party contract manufacturers (17.60% of our total revenue from operations in Fiscal 2026) engaged on a non-exclusive basis:**

We use various third-party contract manufacturers to produce standard, high-volume and low-complexity products such as ceramic and PVT tiles. In Fiscal 2026, we engaged with 304 contract manufacturers, all of which are located in the Morbi cluster of Gujarat in India. Set out below are details of our revenues generated from products manufactured by third-party contract manufacturers for the years indicated:

Particulars	Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	% of Revenue from operations	Amount (₹ million)	% of Revenue from operations	Amount (₹ million)	% of Revenue from operations
Revenue from products manufactured by third party contract manufacturers	2,661.66	17.60%	2,984.09	20.64%	4,620.40	32.19%

Any disruption or non-performance by these third parties may affect our ability to obtain sufficient or desired quantities of products in a timely manner or at acceptable prices, which may adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

- 11. Valuation and market price related risks:** The Offer Price of our Equity Shares, market capitalization to revenue from operations ratio, market capitalization to tangible assets ratio and EV to EBITDA before exceptional items (EBITDA) ratio may not be indicative of the trading price of the Equity Shares upon listing on the Stock Exchanges subsequent to the Offer and, as a result, you may lose a significant part or all of your investment. The table below provides the details of our market capitalization to revenue from operations ratio, market capitalization to tangible assets ratio and EV to EBITDA before exceptional items (EBITDA) ratio at the upper end and lower end of the Price Band as well as the Offer Price for Fiscal 2026:

Particulars*	At the upper end of the Price Band	At the lower end of the Price Band	At Offer Price*
Market capitalization to revenue from operations	2.21	2.10	[●]
Market capitalization to tangible assets	5.53	5.26	[●]
EV to EBITDA before exceptional items (EBITDA)	16.20	15.46	[●]

*To be updated at the Prospectus stage.

Further, set out below are details of our peer group's market capitalization to revenue from operations, market capitalization to tangible assets and EV to EBITDA before exceptional items (EBITDA) for Fiscal 2026:

Listed Peers	Market capitalization to revenue from operations	Market capitalization to tangible assets	EV to EBITDA before exceptional items (EBITDA)
	(in times)		
Kajaria Ceramics Limited	3.03	8.31	16.26
Somany Ceramics Limited	0.53	1.33	6.08
Asian Granito India Limited	0.91	1.78	16.88
Orient Bell Limited	0.54	1.42	8.76

Notes:
1. All the financial information for listed industry peers mentioned above is taken as is sourced from the audited consolidated financial statements and investor presentations of the relevant companies for Fiscal 2026, as available on the websites of the stock exchanges.
2. Market capitalization is the product of outstanding equity shares as of March 31, 2026 multiplied by the closing market price of equity shares on BSE as of March 30, 2026.
3. Tangible assets is calculated as property, plant, and equipment plus capital work in progress plus right of use assets.
4. EV refers to enterprise value and is calculated as market capitalization plus non-current borrowings and current Borrowing less cash and cash equivalents and bank balances other than cash and cash equivalents

12. The Selling Shareholders will receive the entire proceeds from the Offer for Sale. We will not receive or benefit from any proceeds from the Offer for Sale portion
13. Weighted Average Return On Net Worth For Last Three Fiscal Years Is 6.61%
- 14. The Details of Earnings Per Share, Net Asset Value Per Share, Price/Earnings, Return on Net Worth for our Company and peer group are as Follows:**

Name of the Company	Revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	Face value per equity share (₹)	P/E Ratio (x)	EPS (Basic) (₹ per share)	EPS (Diluted) (₹ per share)	RoNW (%)	Net Asset Value per Equity Share (₹ per share)
Varmora Granito Limited	15,124.64	2	48.52^^	3.08	3.05	7.79%	39.52

Listed Peers							
Kajaria Ceramics Limited	48,303.60	1	40.27	30.48	30.44	15.89%	191.11
Somany Ceramics Limited	27,898.40	2	28.55	19.80	19.76	8.79%	202.11
Asian Granito India Limited	18,580.62	10	72.00	0.70	0.70	1.23%	51.36
Orient Bell Limited	6,914.53	10	47.67	8.46	8.43	3.78%	222.78

^^Determined based on Cap Price
For further details and relevant footnotes, please refer to page 131 of the RHP.

- 15. Weighted average cost of acquisition of specified securities of our Promoters and the Investor Selling Shareholder as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows**

Sr. No.	Name of the Promoters/ Selling Shareholder	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each held as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	Weighted Average cost of acquisition per Equity Share of face value of ₹2 each (in ₹)* ⁽¹⁾⁽²⁾
Promoters			
1.	Bhavesh Vallabhdas Varmora	19,351,425	2.45
2.	Hiren R Varmora	19,117,155	3.01
3.	Pramodkumar Parsotambhai Patel	13,416,450	4.36
Investor Selling Shareholder			
1.	Katsura Investments	68,038,093	74.82

*As certified by M/s Doshi Doshi & Co., bearing firm registration number 153683W, pursuant to their certificate dated September 16, 2026.
Notes:
1. Pursuant to a resolution passed by our Board on May 8, 2023 and a resolution passed by the Shareholders on June 7, 2023, our Company sub-divided the face value of its equity shares from ₹10 each to ₹5 each. Accordingly, the number of equity shares of face value ₹5 acquired and average cost of acquisition per equity share, includes the effect of such sub-division.
2. Pursuant to a resolution passed by our Board on December 6, 2024 and a resolution passed by the Shareholders on December 11, 2024, our Company sub-divided the face value of its equity shares from ₹5 each to ₹2 each. Accordingly, the number of equity shares of face value ₹2 acquired and average cost of acquisition per equity share, includes the effect of such sub-division.

- 16. Weighted average cost of all Equity Shares transacted in the three years, 18 months and one year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus**

Period	Weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (in ₹)*^A	Cap Price is 'x' times the weighted average cost of acquisition	Range of acquisition price per Equity Share: lowest price –highest price (in ₹)*@^A
Last one year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	151.78	0.98	2.00-204.59
Last 18 months preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	151.78	0.98	2.00-204.59
Last three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus ⁽¹⁾	99.60	1.49	2.00-204.59

*As certified by M/s Doshi Doshi & Co, with firm registration number 153683W, pursuant to their certificate dated September 16, 2026.
Notes:
^Computed based on the equity shares acquired/allotted/purchased (including acquisition pursuant to transfer and excluding equity shares acquired pursuant to bonus issuances and gifts).
^(1)Pursuant to the resolution passed by our Board on December 6, 2024, and a resolution passed by the Shareholders on December 11, 2024, our Company sub-divided the face value of its equity shares from ₹5 each to ₹2 each. Accordingly, the number of equity shares of face value ₹2 acquired in the preceding periods and weighted average price per equity share, includes the effect of sub-division.
^A Includes the notional price per Equity Share of face value of ₹ 2 each pursuant to conversion of compulsory convertible preference shares into equity shares on December 16, 2024. The consideration of ₹ 10 per compulsorily convertible preference share of face value of ₹10 each, was paid at the time of allotment of these compulsory convertible preference shares.

17. The 3 BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 80 public issues in the past three years, out of which 25 issues closed below the issue price on listing date:

Name of BRLMs	Total Issues	Issues closed below IPO Price as on listing date
JM Financial Limited	37	13
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited	4	2
SBI Capital Markets Limited	22	7
Common Issues of all BRLMs	17	3
Total	80	25

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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. **Pre-IPO Placement - In the Draft Red Herring Prospectus, our Company had provided for a further issue of specified securities through a preferential offer or any other method as may be permitted in accordance with applicable law to any person(s), for an amount aggregating up to ₹800.00 million prior to filing of the Red Herring Prospectus. However, our Company has not undertaken the Pre-IPO Placement.**
2. **Transaction of shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company by the Promoter(s) and members of the Promoter Group:** The details of transaction of shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company by Promoter(s) and members of the Promoter Group from the DRHP filing date is set forth below:

Sr. No.	Date of transfer	Name of the transferor	Name of the transferee^	Nature of transaction	Number of Equity Shares	Percentage of pre-Offer share capital of the Company	Nature of consideration	Transfer price per Equity Share (in ₹)	Total consideration (₹ in million)
1.	October 28, 2025	Katsura Investments	Varmora International	Transfer	2,443,940	1.21%	Cash	204.59*	499.99*

* Rounded off up to two decimal places.

^ Varmora International is a member of the Promoter Group of the Company by virtue of certain immediate relatives of the Promoters who are members of the Promoter Group being partners in Varmora International.



BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

(The "Basis for Offer Price" beginning on page 134 of the RHP has been updated as below. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: www.jmfl.com, www.goldmansachs.com and www.sbicans.com, respectively, for the "Basis for Offer Price" updated with the above Price Band.) (you may scan the QR code for accessing the website of JM Financial Limited)

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/Offer Closing Date*	
Submission of Electronic Applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RILs, other than QIBs and NILs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like Internet Banking, Mobile Banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications) where Bid Amount is more than ₹500,000	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/cancellation of Bids	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors*	Only between 10.00 a.m. on the Bid/Offer Opening Date and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RILs	Only between 10.00 a.m. on the Bid/Offer Opening Date and up to 5.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date

* UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

* QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids.

Bid/ Offer Programme

EVENT	INDICATIVE DATE
Bid/Offer Opened on ⁽¹⁾	Tuesday, September 22, 2026
Bid/Offer Closes on ⁽²⁾⁽³⁾	Thursday, September 24, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the designated Stock Exchange	On or About Friday, September 25, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of Funds from ASBA account	On or About Monday, September 28, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to depository accounts of allottees	On or About Monday, September 28, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or About Tuesday, September 29, 2026

⁽¹⁾ The Anchor Investor Bid/ Offer Period shall be one Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Opening Date in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations i.e., Monday, September 21, 2026

⁽²⁾ Our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may consider closing the Bid/Offer Period for QIB one Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Closing Date in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations.

⁽³⁾ UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

In case of any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the intermediary responsible for causing such delay in unblocking, in the manner specified in the UPI Circulars, to the extent applicable, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated herein. The Book Running Lead Managers shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking.

The Bidder shall be compensated by the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the Self Certified Syndicate Bank(s), to the extent applicable. The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation in compliance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular.

ASBA # Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

Applications supported by blocked amount (ASBA) is a better way of applying to issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

**Mandatory in public issues.
No cheque will be accepted.**



UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non - Institutional Investor applying for amount upto ₹ 500,000/-, applying through Registered Brokers, DPs and RTAs. UPI Bidder also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except anchor investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in ASBA form and abridged prospectus and also please refer to the section "Offer Procedure" on page 470 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("AIBI") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedPfi=yes&intmid=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedPfi=yes&intmid=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORM OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a press release, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the members of the Syndicate and by intimation to Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank, as applicable.

The Offer is being made in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, as amended (the "SCRR"), read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in accordance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("QIBs") (the "QIB Portion"), provided that our Company in consultation with the BRLMs may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors and such allocation will be on a discretionary basis by our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations (the "Anchor Investor Portion"), 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved for allocation in the following manner (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds at or above the price at which allocation is made to Anchor Investors ("Anchor Investor Allocation Price"), and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, as applicable, at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription in (ii) above, the allocation may be made to domestic Mutual Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price, in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (other than the Anchor Investor Portion) (the "Net QIB Portion"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs (except Anchor Investors), including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Investors ("Non-Institutional Portion") of which one-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Bidders with an application size of more than ₹ 0.20 million and up to ₹ 1.00 million and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Bidders with an application size of more than ₹ 1.00 million and undersubscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category of the Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. Further, not less than 35% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Investors ("Retail Portion"), in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. All Bidders (except Anchor Investors) shall mandatorily participate in this Offer only through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") process and shall provide details of their respective bank account (including UPI ID (defined hereinafter) in case of UPI Bidders (defined hereinafter) in which the Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("SCSBs") or pursuant to the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion through the ASBA process. For details, see "Offer Procedure" on page 470 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records

of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 256 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, please see the section titled "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" on page 573 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares

Amount of share capital of our Company and Capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of the Company is ₹ 4,021,005,000 divided into 2,010,502,500 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each, ₹ 500,000 divided into 50,000 equity shares with differential voting rights of face value of ₹ 10 each and ₹ 500,000,000 divided into 50,000,000 compulsorily convertible cumulative and participating preference shares of face value ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of the Company is ₹ 408,780,406 divided into 204,390,203 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each. For details, please see the section titled "Capital Structure" on page 85 of the RHP.

Names of signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company along with their allotment are: Vallabhbhai Jivrajhai Patel, Pramod Parshottambhai Patel, Jagjivanbhai Ganeshbhai Varmora, Bharatbhai Vallabhbhai Patel and Manoj Govindbhai Patel, subscribed to 10,000 equity shares of face value of ₹10 each. For details of the share capital history of our Company, please see the section titled "Capital Structure" beginning on page 85 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares, to be offered through the Red Herring Prospectus, are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to letters each dated November 12, 2025. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A copy of the Red Herring Prospectus and the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus until the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" on page 573 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the Offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities or the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 448 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 451 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE : It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Red Herring Prospectus has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. The investors are advised to refer to page 451 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General Risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by the Securities and Exchange Board of India, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "Risk Factors" on page 19 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS			REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
				Nilesh Sharma 1004/5/6, South Tower, ONE42, Off. Iscon-Ambli Road, Ahmedabad - 380 054, Gujarat, India. Telephone: + 91 - 9909913657 E-mail: investor.relations@varmora.com
JM Financial Limited 7 th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030 E-mail: vgl ipo@jmfl.com Investor grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com Website: www.jmfl.com Contact person: Prachee Dhuri SEBI registration number: INM000010361	Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited 9 th and 10 th Floor, Ascent-Worli, Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000 E-mail: varmoraipo@gs.com Investor grievance E-mail: india-client-support @gs.com Website: www.goldmansachs.com Contact person: Mayur Khule SEBI registration number: INM000011054	SBI Capital Markets Limited 1501, 15 th floor, A & B Wing, Parinee Crescenzo, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807 E-mail: varmora.ipo@sbicans.com Investor grievance E-mail: investor.relations@sbicans.com Website: www.sbicans.com Contact person: Kritika Shetty/ Sylvia Mendonca SEBI registration number: INM000003531	KFin Technologies Limited Selenium, Tower B, Plot No. 31 and 32, Gachibowli, Financial District Nanakramguda, Serilingampally, Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India Telephone: + 91 40 6716 2222 E-mail: vgl.ipo@kfintech.com Investor Grievance E-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com Website: www.kfintech.com Contact Person: M. Murali Krishna SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221	Bidders can contact our Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related queries, grievances and for redressal of complaints including queries, grievances and for redressal of complaints including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer-related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled "Risk Factors" beginning on page 19 of the RHP, before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP shall be available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, and on the website of the Company at www.varmora.com and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. JM Financial Limited, Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited and SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.jmfl.com, www.goldmansachs.com and www.sbicans.com, respectively

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the abridged prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at www.varmora.com, www.jmfl.com, www.goldmansachs.com, www.sbicans.com and www.kfintech.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **VARMORA GRANITO LIMITED, Telephone: + 91 – 9909913657; BRLMs : JM Financial Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030, Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000 and SBI Capital Markets Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807 and Syndicate Members: JM Financial Services Limited, Tel.: +91 22 6136 3400, SBICAP Securities Limited, Tel.: 91-22-69432521, and Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited, Tel.: +91 2268497400, and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members, SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.**

Sub-Syndicate Members: Almondz Global Securities Limited, Ambit Capital Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Asit C. Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Capital Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, Globe Capital Market Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, IIFL Capital Services Limited, IIFL Wealth Management Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Ltd, Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Ltd, Religare Securities Limited, RR Equity Brokers Pvt. Ltd, Sharekhan Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, YES SECURITIES (INDIA) Limited

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

Escrow Collection Bank and Refund Bank: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited • **Public Offer Account Banks :** HDFC Bank Limited • **Sponsor Banks :** Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

For **VARMORA GRANITO LIMITED**
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Nilesh Sharma
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place: Rajkot, Gujarat
Date: September 22, 2026

VARMORA GRANITO LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC, Gujarat at Ahmedabad on September 16, 2026, and subsequently with the SEBI and the Stock Exchanges. The RHP shall be available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of our Company at www.varmora.com and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited and SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.jmfl.com, www.goldmansachs.com and www.sbicans.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see "Risk Factors" beginning on page 19 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges, and should instead rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision.

The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the "U.S. Securities Act") or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, such Equity Shares are being offered and sold in offshore transactions as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where those offers and sales occur.

The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered, listed or otherwise qualified in any other jurisdiction outside India and may not be offered or sold, and Bids may not be made by persons in any such jurisdiction except in compliance with the applicable laws of such jurisdiction. There will be no public offering in the United States.

HONOURING THE REAL HEROES WHO MAKE A DIFFERENCE



The evening started with the audience rising for national song Vande Mataram



(from left) Ramesh Rangarajan, Chairman, KSL; K Venugopal, Director, KSL; Nirmala Lakshman, Director and Publisher, The Hindu Group; Nirmala Sitharaman, Finance Minister; R Vijay Anandh, MD and CEO, City Union Bank; Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, businessline; Prabhask Bose, CGM, SBI - Delhi Circle, and LV Navaneeth, CEO, The Hindu Group, at the release of the Changemaker tabloid PHOTOS BY BIJOY GHOSH



Members of the audience in rapt attention



S Krishnan (left), Secretary, MeitY, with V Anantha Nageswaran, CEA



FM Nirmala Sitharaman with the Directors of The Hindu Group and Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, businessline



Jury members (from left) A Balasubramanian, MD & CEO, Aditya Birla SunLife Mutual Fund; NS Nappinai, Senior Advocate, Supreme Court of India; Safeena Husain, Founder, Educate Girls; Mukund Rajan, Chairperson, ECube Investment, with R Vijay Anandh, MD and CEO, City Union Bank, and Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, businessline



A musical performance at the event

From a girl told to ‘settle down’ to a woman who led girls back to school

Our Bureau
New Delhi

When Safeena Husain looks back at her childhood, the story of Educate Girls does not begin in a village classroom or an NGO office. It begins in Delhi with her childhood, which she describes as “very turbulent” and when her own education came to a halt.

In a fireside chat at businessline Changemaker Awards 2026 with Richa Mishra, Resident Editor, Hyderabad, Husain, Founder of Educate Girls and a businessline Changemaker awardee herself, said she grew up in difficult neighbourhoods of Delhi such as Paharganj, Nauroji Nagar and Saket. It was not a childhood marked by privilege, she said, adding that Delhi was a difficult place to grow up in those years.

Her education was interrupted for several years. While others moved ahead to college, Husain found herself being described as the girl who was “not doing anything”. The advice from the neighbourhood was familiar: Get her married and settle her down.

Eventually, Husain got the opportunity to go to the London School of Economics (LSE), the first person in her family to study overseas. “It changed my life,” she recalled.

Years later, that experience would become the



CHARGED UP. Safeena Husain (right), Founder, Educate Girls, in a fireside chat with Richa Mishra, Resident Editor, businessline, at the businessline Changemaker Awards 2026 in New Delhi on Tuesday SHIV KUMAR PUSHKAPAKAR

foundation of an organisation that has worked to bring girls who have never enrolled in school, dropped out or experienced interruptions in education back into learning.

‘MY EVERYTHING’
Husain’s first instinct was not to start an NGO. After LSE, she moved to San Francisco and began her development-sector career after spending about nine months in Silicon Valley. She went on to work in community health in Ecuador, Mexico, Bolivia and South

Husain terms patriarchy as a mindset that people have to unlearn rather than a community’s problem

Africa, including with indigenous communities in the Amazon and Oaxaca, Mexico. The turning point came when she was setting up a clinic in the mountains between Dehradun and Mussoorie, back in India.

Proud of the work she was doing, Husain invited her father to see the clinic. Villagers gathered around him and began asking questions about his family. When he said Husain was his only child, his only daughter, the mood changed. There was silence, she recalled. The women around him appeared almost mournful. They told him he was still young and should remarry and “try again” for a son.

Her father simply put his arm around her and said: “This is my son, this is my daughter, this is my everything.”

THE PREJUDICE EXISTS
For Husain, however, the moment was about the girls who could not simply leave the village. “My father and I can,” she remembered thinking. “But what about all the girls who are there?”

In villages, she still encounters the attitude that treats a girl as a liability and an animal as an asset. Investing in a daughter, she said, can be viewed as “watering a neighbour’s garden”. But Husain is careful not to place the problem solely at the doors of rural India.

The prejudice, she argued, exists across society, albeit in different degrees. “Patriarchy stains us all,” she said, describing it as a mindset that people have to unlearn rather than a problem belonging only to a particular community.

‘Meaningful change comes from countless decisions, sustained effort’

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Meaningful change does not happen in a single moment but is shaped by numerous decisions and persistent effort, Nirmala Lakshman, Director, The Hindu Group of Publications, said on Tuesday.

Speaking at the 8th businessline Changemaker Awards, Lakshman said some of the most meaningful journeys begin without applause or certainty, but with an idea, persistence and the courage to stay the course even when the outcome is not immediately visible.

“Meaningful change is not built in a single moment. It’s built through countless decisions, sustained effort and the belief that what we do today can somehow make tomorrow different,” she said.

Lakshman said change was visible across businesses, technologies, communities and the way individuals and institutions responded to challenges, but behind every meaningful change was someone willing to ask whether things could be done differently or better.

“That willingness to question, to persist, and to act — that is what makes a changemaker,” she said.

CREATING IMPACT
The individuals and organ-



GRAND WELCOME. Nirmala Lakshman, Director, The Hindu Group, and Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, businessline, presenting a memento to Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman BIJOY GHOSH

isations being recognised at the awards came from different sectors and had different approaches to creating impact, but shared a common thread — they had chosen to create change rather than wait for it.

“Some have challenged established ways of thinking, some have built solutions where none existed, some have transformed businesses, while others have transformed lives and communities,” Lakshman observed.

She stressed that innovation did not necessarily have to be disruptive and impact did not always have to be measured by scale.

At times, she said, it could

mean solving a difficult problem, creating something that outlives its creator, or simply having the courage to begin.

SHARP INSIGHTS
Lakshman also underlined the role of credible journalism in enabling change. She said The Hindu Group, with its nearly 150-year legacy, believed in the power of credible information to inform, question, empower and shape public discourse.

“Business journalism today is not just about markets and numbers; it’s about understanding the forces that shape livelihoods, innovation, and our larger economy,” she said.

She said businessline had carried that legacy into business and economics through sharp insights, informed analysis and perspectives that helped readers navigate an increasingly complex world.

The Changemaker Awards, she said, extended that role beyond the newsroom by recognising individuals and organisations shaping the future.

The awards, she said, were not merely a celebration of success but of “purpose, perseverance and possibility”.

“Change is not something we merely witness; it’s something that each of us can contribute to,” she said.

QUICKLY.

PhonePe gets UAE nod to build payments business

Bengaluru: PhonePe has secured in-principle approval from the Central Bank of the UAE for two payment licences, marking the fintech's first step towards setting up a payments business outside India. The approvals are for Retail Payment Services and Card Schemes (RPSCS) and Stored Value Facilities (SVF). PhonePe will need to secure final regulatory nod before it can commence commercial operations. **OUR BUREAU**

Engineers India wins \$450-million contract

New Delhi: Engineers India, the State-run engineering consultancy, has signed a contract worth more than \$450 million to serve as project management and EPCM consultant for the Dangote Group's planned 7,00,000-barrel-per-day greenfield refinery and petrochemical plant in Kenya, extending a partnership forged on Africa's largest refinery. **PTI**

Sharad Pawar backs Noel Tata, says Tata group must be protected

WORDS OF ADVICE. Senior politician urges dialogue and due process in Tata Sons leadership dispute

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Tata Group's charitable ownership must be protected, Nationalist Congress Party (SP) chief Sharad Pawar has said while throwing his weight behind Noel Tata in his fight to keep Tata Sons private.

The issue of listing Tata Sons and its Chairman N Chandrasekaran's third term has pitted Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata against the company's board members. Tata has called the resolution appointing Chandrasekaran as illegal, and is preparing for a legal challenge.

'DIALOGUE NEEDED'
"The Tata Group is a national institution rooted in Maharashtra, and its charit-

able ownership must be protected," Pawar said in a tweet on X. "The Articles adopted by shareholders that give trust-nominated directors an affirmative vote on key decisions including the Chairman's appointment should be honoured."

"Leadership decisions should be settled with the consent of Tata Trusts, as the majority owner, through dialogue and due process rather than disputes," Pawar said.

Pawar, who is currently a Rajya Sabha Member of Parliament, has close ties with business houses and has shaped industrial development during his tenure as Maharashtra's Chief Minister. The octogenarian leader has also mediated in the past to resolve disputes within Bajaj and other industrial groups. "Maharashtra is fortunate to be at the heart of



Nationalist Congress Party (SP) chief Sharad Pawar



Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata **REUTERS**

Tata's legacy," Pawar remarked, pointing to the presence of institutions like the Tata Memorial Hospital, the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, the Tata Institute of Social Sciences and the National Centre for Performing Arts.

"Weakening the Trusts weakens the institutions that the country and State's

people depend on," he said.

DECISIVE VOICE
The Tata Sons Articles of Association give the majority owner's nominees a decisive voice in choosing the chairman, and that agreement should be respected as that is the very design of the Tata group, Pawar said. The NCP leader's views echo those of

JSW eyes top-tier commercial vehicle spot with ₹2,000-cr bet

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The JSW Group is committing ₹2,000 crore to enter the electric commercial vehicle market, with Chairman Sajjan Jindal outlining plans to pursue a top-three position through organic expansion and acquisitions, while building towards an electric truck fleet of one lakh vehicles by around 2030.

JSW Group is betting ₹2,000 crore on its entry into electric trucks and buses, and is open to acquisitions to accelerate its push to become one of India's top two or three commercial vehicle makers, Chairman Sajjan Jindal said, taking the conglomerate into an industry dominated by established truck manufacturers.

erate into an industry dominated by established truck manufacturers.

JSW Greentech will start with a 90-acre factory in Chhatrapati Sambhajanagar, capable of producing 15,000 vehicles annually, including 10,000 electric buses and 5,000 electric trucks. But Jindal describes the facility as an "entry strategy". His longer-term ambition is to build an electric truck business capable of producing up to one lakh vehicles annually by around 2030. "Once we as JSW Group get into that area, then we would also want to be one of the largest players, among the top two or three in the market," Jindal said during an exclusive media preview ahead of the commercial



Sajjan Jindal

EV brand launch. JSW is prepared to use acquisitions alongside organic expansion to achieve that goal, extending a strategy Jindal has used to build scale in other businesses.

SHIFT TO ELECTRIC
Jindal believes the shift to

electric vehicles gives a newcomer an unusual opening because JSW is entering the commercial vehicle market without decades of investment in diesel engines and related technologies to protect. "In any industry, the existing players can become a little complacent," he said, arguing that companies that have already invested in "the engine plant, in the technology, in everything" can be slower to embrace a radically different technology.

JSW, by contrast, is starting with an electric-only commercial vehicle operation. The first truck will be a 55-tonne tractor-trailer, followed by tippers, fixed-body trucks and dumpers. Its electric bus portfolio is planned

to span vehicles from 7 metres to 18 metres, covering city transit, staff transport, school bus and airport applications. Jindal said trucks are particularly attractive because their high utilisation magnifies the savings potential from replacing diesel. "We are more excited about the trucks because that, I feel, will be a game changer for India," he said.

The economics, however, remain challenging. JSW estimates that a truck travelling one lakh km annually at around 2.5 km per litre could consume roughly 40,000 litres of diesel, costing about ₹40 lakh a year at ₹100 per litre. That is where JSW believes electric trucks can transform the economics

despite their higher purchase price.

FROM SCRATCH
The Sambhajanagar plant will integrate cell-to-battery-pack manufacturing, truck cabin production and in-house bus body construction. JSW also says it will house India's first commercial vehicle plant with a pre-treatment and electro-deposition facility.

For Jindal, the commercial vehicle venture is part industrial opportunity and part bet that electrification can reduce India's dependence on imported oil. He acknowledges that taking on established truckmakers will require JSW to master an industry in which it has little legacy experience.

FMCG companies expect 9-11% festival demand growth even as consumers remain value-conscious

Jyoti Banthia
Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

FMCG companies are heading into the festival season expecting demand growth of 9-11 per cent, but early consumption trends suggest that consumers remain selective about where they spend, with larger baskets and higher volumes taking precedence over a broad-based willingness to pay more.

Gaurav Manchanda, Founder and Director, Nimda Group, which owns The Organic World and WellBe, said, "There was a clear improvement in consumer sentiment, although the recovery was not yet broad-based. There is definitely a sense of improvement in consumer sentiment, but I would not describe it as an across-the-board recovery just yet. The consumer is still being quite



PREMIUM DEMAND. Consumers are willing to spend on products that offer value proposition

deliberate about where they spend," Manchanda said. Industry estimates are pointing to 9-11 per cent FMCG demand growth through the August-November period, he said. Consumers are showing a willingness to spend on products that offer a value proposition, with premiumisation visible particularly among urban consumers.

MEASURED PRICING
The trend towards higher festive consumption is visible in larger packs and increased

unit purchases rather than higher per-unit realisations, said Ashwin Shetty, Vice-President - Growth and Digital Marketing, Two Brothers India Farms. "The festive consumer doesn't pay more per unit — our realisation per unit was flat during *Navratri*, but they buy more units (+20 per cent) in bigger packs (+12 per cent). It's a stock-up behaviour, not a splurge behaviour," Shetty said. He said premiumisation and value consumption were not necessarily contradictory trends.

"Within the festive fortnight, there's no trade-up; the mix actually shifts slightly toward value. Structurally, over 12 months, premium and convenience are steadily growing," he said.

This is also reflected in the broader pricing environment, where companies are attempting to absorb part of the rise in input costs rather than pass on the entire increase to consumers during the festive period. "We have been fairly measured on pricing. The objective has been to absorb as much of the input-cost pressure as we reasonably can through efficiencies, product mix and operational measures rather than immediately passing the entire increase on to the consumer," Manchanda said.

At Two Brothers, Shetty said the company had not taken a price increase despite higher commodity costs. "Cocoa cost jumped 48 per

cent quarter-on-quarter, yet most FMCG firms have taken minimal increases, but Pluckk is yet to take a price increase and plans to hold through the festive months. Everyone's eating the cost to protect volume right now; that's a quarter's strategy, not a year's," he said.

Manchanda said companies were prioritising volumes and were willing to absorb some margin pressure. "The current industry commentary is clear that companies are prioritising volume through the festive season and are willing to carry some margin pressure to do that," he said. However, he said companies were likely to reassess pricing after the festive period depending on commodity prices, demand and margin pressures. "Pricing decisions will be much more calibrated than simply passing on the entire commodity increase," he said.

Zetwerk, Ayr Energy settle legal dispute, seek termination of USITC probe

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses and US-based Ayr Energy have reached a global settlement, bringing an end to the legal disputes between them, their respective affiliates and individuals.

The two companies have agreed to dismiss all claims in lawsuits pending before the Texas Business Court, as well as claims in a separate case involving Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses and Anirudh Reddy before the XXXV additional city civil and sessions judge in Bengaluru.

The companies have jointly sought termination of the related investigation by the US International Trade Commission (USITC).

The settlement brings closure to a dispute that escalated across courts in the US and India, involving al-

The global settlement resolves disputes spanning Texas courts, Bengaluru proceedings and the USITC probe

legations related to transformer technology and proprietary information.

LEGAL BATTLE

Zetwerk and its US subsidiary Unimacts had earlier sued Ayr Energy and its co-founder Anirudh Reddy in Texas. Zetwerk had alleged that Reddy, who had worked as a senior executive at the company, had set up Ayr while still associated with Zetwerk and had misappropriated confidential information, including customer and pricing-related data, to build a competing business. Ayr subsequently filed

counterclaims against Zetwerk and also approached the USITC, alleging that Zetwerk had improperly obtained proprietary information relating to transformer technology.

Ayr sought remedies that included restrictions on imports of the disputed transformers into the US.

The USITC instituted a Section 337 investigation following Ayr's complaint. The commission's investigation was separate from the ongoing court proceedings and had not represented a final finding on the merits of Ayr's allegations.

The global settlement now resolves the outstanding claims between the parties.

The joint request to terminate the USITC investigation is part of the agreement, bringing the dispute to a close across the multiple jurisdictions.

Bridge Green inks \$1 b deal for lithium carbonate supply

Our Bureau
Chennai

Bridge Green Upcycle, a US-based company specialising in recovering critical minerals from scrap lithium-ion batteries, has entered into a commercial agreement, valued at \$0.5-1 billion, with American commodities trading firm Hartree Partners.

Bridge Green operates a critical mineral recovery

plant for lithium-ion batteries in Chennai, with a processing capacity of 7,200 tonnes per annum.

Under the partnership, Hartree will purchase and market approximately 10,000 tonnes of lithium carbonate produced by Bridge Green per year for an eight-year term.

The parties can renew the agreement for an additional seven years.

EQUITY INVESTMENT
The agreement coincides with an equity investment by Hartree in Bridge Green's bridge financing round, which aims to fund Bridge Green's planned expansion of battery recycling and critical mineral refining.

The first lithium carbonate volumes under the agreement are projected in 2028.

'Mahindra, India passenger-vehicle market headed for another record year'

bl.interview

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Nalinikanth Gollagunta has handled seven successful launches at Mahindra & Mahindra, a journey he sums up as "never a dull moment."

His eighth is the refreshed three-door Thar. When questioned if Mahindra is set for a new record, Gollagunta, CEO - Automotive Division, says, "We have enough momentum to end the year on a high."

Edited excerpts:

You are nearing four years at Mahindra and have handled seven launches. How would you sum up the journey?
Never a dull moment. Every day is new and challenging. It is the most exciting automotive market anywhere in the

world. I look forward to the next four years.

Why refresh the three-door Thar now when the five-door Thar Roxx has widened the brand's appeal?
The new Thar opened up that market in 2020 by combining off-road capability with comfort. Feedback then led us to build the larger Thar Roxx.

We have now brought capabilities from other products to the authentic three-door off-roader. The result combines greater capability with improved on-road comfort.

What are the principal changes?
The M-Glyde 4G platform and Pentalink rear suspension with a Watts link come from the Roxx. We have added DAVINCI damping, an electronic locking differential, leatherette seats and a



Dealer stock may be 10-15 per cent above our normal one-month stock, but we expect it to be absorbed quickly

NALINIKANTH GOLLAGUNTA
CEO - Automotive Division, M&M



second-row armrest. The creature comforts are upgraded, but the core capability has also been fundamentally rewired.

Combined Thar and Roxx volumes rose 49 per cent to 1,26,261 in FY26, but Roxx accounted for about 65 per cent. Are you concerned about cannibalisation?
We have enough manufacturing fungibility for demand to

go either way. We do not try to determine which model will cannibalise the other; let customers decide. Whichever way demand goes, we should be able to cater to it.

More importantly, the portfolio has to stay fresh. Almost every product has been refreshed over the past 12 months; the three-door Thar was the exception. Going into the festive season, we want the entire portfolio fresh and updated.

How are demand, supply and dealer inventories looking ahead of the festive season?

Demand is fairly robust across the portfolio. We had supply-chain constraints in June and July, largely due to capacity constraints at tier-two suppliers, but those are now behind us. In August, production was fairly close to our peak capacity.

Dealer stock may be in the 33-35-day range. That is healthy for the season. It may be 10-15 per cent above our normal one-month stock, but we expect it to be absorbed quickly.

Will discounts be needed to drive festive sales?

Discounts are always part of the strategy, including tactical responses in certain markets, but there is nothing explicitly special this time.

Given the demand scenario, I do not see discounting as a core way to drive sales. This launch is meant to give customers a reason to buy during the festive season.

Mahindra sold a record 6.6 lakh SUVs last year, and India sold 46.43 lakh passenger vehicles. Can both set new records this year?

That is a no-brainer in my mind. We have enough momentum to end the year on a high. For Mahindra, we have spoken about mid-to-high-teens growth, and we are sticking to that projection. The industry should end the year on a high, based on the momentum seen in the first half. Sentiment is good, and most prices across the industry remain below pre-GST levels despite inflationary challenges. Demand should continue.

India Inc likely to step up corporate bond issuances

STRATEGIC MOVE. Companies seek to mobilise capital before borrowing costs rise

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

India Inc may step up corporate bond issuances in the run up to the Reserve Bank of India's upcoming bi-monthly monetary policy review meeting, which is expected to kick-start a rate hike cycle amid rising inflationary pressures.

Companies may prefer mobilising funds at lower rates before the borrowing costs go up.

The central bank's rate setting panel — the Monetary Policy Committee — is seen raising the policy repo rate by 25 basis points from 5.25 per cent to 5.5 per cent at its three-day meeting beginning October 5 to tamp down price pressures.

This could have a ripple effect, resulting in an increase in the cost of borrowing for corporates.

In the current financial year so far (up to September 21, 2026), India Inc has mopped up ₹5,09,777 crore via debt private placement (DPP) *vis-a-vis* the year ago period's ₹5,21,666 crore, according to Prime Database.

CLEAR CHANGE

While DPP in the current financial year so far is just about



RECORD MOP-UP

- In the current fiscal (up to September 21, 2026), India Inc has mopped up ₹5,09,777 crore via debt private placement
- Corporates raised ₹76,026 crore via DPP in September so far against ₹67,006 crore in August 2026

2 per cent lower as compared to the year-ago period, it is gathering momentum.

As per data compiled by Prime Database, corporates raised ₹76,026 crore *via* DPP in September so far (up to 21*) against ₹67,006 crore in August 2026.

Venkatakrishnan Srinivasan, Founder & Managing Partner, Rockfort Fin-cap LLP, observed that the Indian corporate bond market is witnessing a clear change in issuer behaviour, with many large corporates and banking and financial services issuers bringing for-

ward their borrowing plans while the funding environment is still supported by exceptionally high system liquidity.

"Issuers with near-term funding requirements are, therefore, looking at the current window to secure funds before the full impact of a potential rate and liquidity repricing gets reflected across the yield curve. The growing expectation of at least a 25 basis points repo rate hike in October is already influencing issuer behaviour. There is a visible trend among companies to tie up funds before

the next leg of the rate cycle," he said.

BORROWING LINE-UP

In this regard, Venkatakrishnan cited the example of Reliance Industries returning to the domestic bond market after nearly three years with a ₹12,500 crore five-year issue at a 7.47 per cent coupon.

Several large public sector enterprises, banking & financial services players and private corporate issuers have also been active in the current month.

Moreover, what is particularly noticeable is the breadth of issuers returning to the market in September, with Reliance, REC, PFC, SIDBI, Canara Bank, Bajaj Finance, Tata Capital, HDB Financial Services and Shriram Finance being among the large names that have been active or prominent in the September borrowing line-up

"The current behaviour suggests that issuers are increasingly willing to accept the prevailing coupon rather than take the risk of substantially higher funding costs later. If the current momentum continues, September could potentially see corporate bond issuances cross ₹1 lakh crore," per Venkatakrishnan's assessment.

RBI absorbs ₹71,971 crore through VRRR auction

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India on Tuesday absorbed ₹71,971 crore from the banking system through an overnight variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auction amid a huge surplus. The central bank re-

ceived bids worth ₹71,971 crore, which it accepted fully, for a notified amount of ₹75,000 crore, according to an official release.

CUT-OFF BIDS

The bids were accepted at a cut-off and weighted average rate of 5.24 per cent, the release said.

The RBI has been conducting various VRRR auctions since last month in order to absorb surplus liquidity from the banking system and align the overnight money market rates to the repo rate. Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of around ₹4.92 lakh crore as of September

21, as per the RBI data. The central bank also conducted two open market operations (OMO) resulting in sales of government securities worth ₹50,000 crore on September 17 and ₹25,000 crore on September 21. The remaining last tranche of ₹25,000 crore is scheduled for September 28.

APPOINTMENT



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(An autonomous body set up by Reserve Bank of India, Central Financial Institutions and Public Sector Banks)

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Sr. No.	Name of the Post	Type of employment	Important Dates / schedule
1.	Banker Faculty	Contract Basis	On-line Registration of Applications ---- From 23.09.2026 to 06.10.2026
2.	Banker Faculty-Technical	Contract Basis	
3.	Executive Secretary to Director	Contract Basis	
4.	Hindi Officer	Regular Basis	
5.	Server Administrator	Regular Basis	Walk-in selection process on Wednesday, 30.09.2026 at IBPS, Mumbai

For more details, kindly visit our website www.ibps.in.

Date : 23.09.2026

Sd/-
Division Head (Administration)

Rupee rebound faces significant headwinds

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The rupee recovered 37 paise against the dollar over the past week despite the strength in the greenback. The dollar index, currently at 100.35, gained about 0.7 per cent during this period.

WEEKLY RUPEE VIEW.

A decline in the US Treasury yields offered some support to the local currency. The US 10-year Treasury yield fell from 5.01 per cent last Tuesday to 4.93 per cent currently, easing some of the pressure on the rupee.

Foreign portfolio flows, however, remain a headwind. According to NSDL data, net FPI outflows stood at about \$600 million over the past week, taking the cumulative outflows in September to \$3.1 billion. So far this year, net outflows have crossed \$19 billion.

Meanwhile, some relief has emerged on the crude oil front. Oil prices moderated as reports indicated an improvement in shipments through the Strait of Hormuz. Oil flows through the strait have reportedly improved as Saudi Arabia increased exports to about 2.9 million barrels per day compared with 0.7 million barrels per day in August, helping cap the rally in crude prices.

Overall, lower crude oil prices and the decline in US Treasury yields have provided some breathing space for the rupee. However, a firm dollar and persistent foreign outflows

could limit the extent of the recovery.

CHART

The rupee, after falling to a two-month low of 96.1 last Thursday, changed direction and has been rising since then. On Tuesday, it closed at 95.59. As it stands, the upward momentum appears good and the rupee might extend the upside, possibly to 95.4. But after this rise, the local currency is likely to resume to downtrend. Notable support levels from the current level are 95.8 and 96.1 followed by 96.25.

Instead, if the rupee surpasses the resistance at 95.4, it could face a hurdle at 95.2. A clear breach of 95.2 could lift it further to 94.9 in the near-term. The dollar index has been steadily rallying for nearly two weeks.

But currently trading at 100.35, there is a resistance ahead at 100.5. This could lead to a minor correction. The dip could take the dollar index to 100. The rupee could gain ground in the near-term from this decline.

An eventual breakout of 100.5 could take the dollar index to 101, a hurdle. Resistance above 101 can be spotted at 101.6. This uptick in the index can weigh on the rupee.

OUTLOOK

The rupee can extend the recovery towards 95.4 in the near term, aided by softer crude oil prices and lower US yields. However, the broader bias remains weak, with a firm dollar and persistent foreign outflows likely to cap gains and push rupee back towards 95.8-96.1.

Centre to decide on airport operators owning airlines

Our Bureau
New Delhi

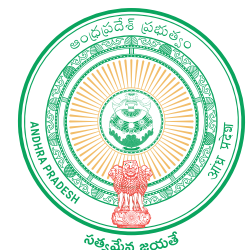
The Centre is examining the implications of airport operators owning airlines and *vice versa*, and will take a balanced approach, Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu said on Tuesday. Speaking on the sidelines of an event, the Minister said no decision had been taken yet and the matter remained under deliberation. He was responding to a question on the Adani Group's interest in starting an airline. At present, the Adani

Group operates several airports under the public-private partnership model.

DELIBERATION NEEDED

"However, airports and airlines operating together require deliberation. We will examine the pros and cons and take a balanced approach," he said.

Besides, the Minister said there was no general government rule preventing airport operators from owning airlines, apart from provisions in the operation, management and development agreements for Delhi and Mumbai airports.



ANDHRA PRADESH

A NEW ERA OF INDUSTRIAL GROWTH

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Andhra Pradesh Bulk Drug Park : Powering the Next Phase of Pharma Growth

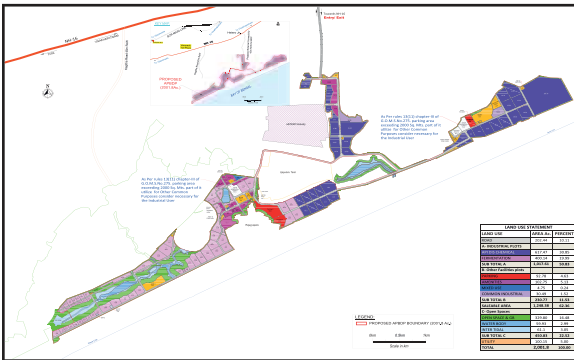
Andhra Pradesh is emerging as a key destination for pharmaceutical manufacturing with the development of the Nakkapalli Bulk Drug Park in Anakapalli district. Established under the Government of India Bulk Drug Park Scheme, the project is designed to provide world-class infrastructure for the production of bulk drugs and Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (APIs). Spread across nearly 2,000 acres, the park will offer integrated facilities including roads, power, water supply, common effluent treatment systems, testing laboratories, warehousing, solvent recovery units, and research infrastructure, creating a robust ecosystem for pharmaceutical manufacturers.

Common Infrastructure Facilities

- Internal Roads: 31.01 km
- Common Logistics Area: 80 acres
- Stormwater Drains: 62.02 km
- Boundary Fencing: 44.76 km

Utilities

- 24x7 supply of potable, purified and recycled water
- Water distribution network
- Wastewater Management
- Reliable Power Supply
- Smart Solutions:



- Solvent Storage & Recovery
- Steam Generation & Distribution
- Common Warehousing:
- Solid Waste Management Facilities
- Green and Clean Solutions

Technology Centres

- Common Laboratory Testing & R&D Centre
- Centre of Excellence
- Park-Level Management Centre
- MSME Support & Development Centre
- Emergency Response Centre

Strategically located along the Visakhapatnam-Chennai Industrial Corridor (VCIC) and close to major ports, the park is expected to attract investments of over 11,500 crore and generate thousands of employment opportunities, strengthening Andhra Pradesh position as a leading pharmaceutical hub in India.

With Phase I targeted for completion by 2026, the Nakkapalli Bulk Drug Park represents a major step toward boosting domestic API production, reducing import dependence, and driving industrial growth in the state.

Vision

The Bulk Drug Park aims to create a smart, integrated pharmaceutical ecosystem that reduces manufacturing costs, promotes innovation, supports MSMEs, and strengthens Andhra Pradesh's position as a leading pharmaceutical and API manufacturing destination in India.

CHIEF MINISTER'S VISION

To build Andhra Pradesh as a cornerstone of Viksit Bharat—a globally competitive manufacturing hub powered by renewable energy, advanced technologies, and world class infrastructure. Our vision is to attract international investment, foster innovation and create inclusive prosperity, ensuring sustainable growth and opportunities for all.



One Family, One Entrepreneur

The Government of Andhra Pradesh is implementing the ambitious 175 MSME Parks Programme under the flagship "One Family, One Entrepreneur" initiative, with the objective of establishing one MSME Park in every Assembly Constituency across the State.

The programme is designed to promote balanced regional industrial development, encourage entrepreneurship, generate large-scale employment opportunities, and provide world-class plug-and-play industrial infrastructure for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs). The initiative encompasses a combination of MSME Parks, Flatted Factory Complexes (FFCs), and select private industrial parks, creating an enabling ecosystem for enterprises to establish and expand their operations efficiently.

Significant progress has been achieved under the programme:

- **Phase I (55 Constituencies):** Inaugurations have been completed in 19 MSME Parks, while foundation stones have been laid for 36 MSME Parks. The parks under this phase are being developed with a proposed land development investment of Rs.592.27/- crore.
- **Phase II (45 Constituencies):** Inaugurations have been com-

pleted in 3 constituencies, and foundation stones have been laid in 42 constituencies. The proposed land development investment under this phase is approximately Rs.583.47/- crore.

- **Phase III (38 Constituencies):** Foundation stones have already been laid for 38 constituencies, with a proposed land development investment of approximately Rs.228.33/- crore.

- For the remaining 37 constituencies, land identification and acquisition activities are currently in progress, and development works will be initiated shortly.

- Overall, out of the 175 Assembly Constituencies in Andhra Pradesh, MSME Parks have either been inaugurated or foundation stones have been laid in 138 constituencies, representing nearly 79% coverage under the programme. The remaining constituencies are expected to be under implementation in the coming months.

- As of date, 1,008 industrial allotments have been made in 28 MSME parks, spanning 309

acres. The allotted units envisage a total investment of ₹2,036 crore and have the potential to create employment for 31,163.

- The initiative comprises of Industrial parks and Flatted Factory Complexes. The low plot size enables more people to start industries and low lock in capital on land.



"One Family, One Entrepreneur" is a flagship economic initiative launched by the government of Andhra Pradesh to foster a culture of business and self-reliance in every household by 2030.

The 175 MSME Parks Programme is expected to create a robust industrial ecosystem, foster entrepreneurship at the grassroots level, attract investments, and generate sustainable employment opportunities, thereby contributing significantly to Andhra Pradesh's vision of inclusive and balanced economic development.

INDUSTRIAL CORRIDORS IN ANDHRA PRADESH

KRISHNAPATNAM INDUSTRIAL AREA

Chennai - Bengaluru Industrial Corridor - Nellore
A US\$ 1.19 Billion (Rs.10,500 Cr) Greenfield Investment Opportunity in South India



- 2,006.09 Acres
- 10,500 Cr. Investment Potential
- 98,000 Jobs

Total Saleable Area - 1276.4 (Acres)

Industrial	Commercial	Residential	Amenities & Utilities	Warehousing/ MMLH Land
872.7	13.2	246.9	42.9	100.7

Industrial Sale Value 1.75 Cr./Acre

Trunk infrastructure is completed to an extent of 50%.
Focus Sectors: Automobiles & Auto Components, Electronic System Design & Manufacturing, Agro & Food Processing, Pharmaceuticals & Biotechnology, Textiles & Apparels

ORVAKAL INDUSTRIAL AREA

Hyderabad - Bengaluru Industrial Corridor - Kurnool
A US\$ 1.61 Billion (Rs.12,000 Cr) Greenfield Investment Opportunity in South India



- 2,621.15 Acres
- 12,000 Cr. Investment Potential
- 45,071 Jobs

Total Saleable Area - 1671.82 (Acres)

Industrial	Commercial	Residential	Amenities & Utilities	Warehousing/ MMLH Land
1423.7	17.56	41.98	64.49	124.06

Industrial Sale Value 1.75 Cr./Acre

Trunk infrastructure is completed to an extent of 20%.
Focus Sectors: Non-Metallic Minerals, Auto Components, Aerospace & Defence Hardware, Pharmaceuticals, Renewables, Electrical & Electronic Components, Gems & Jewellery, Textile & Apparel.

KOPPARTHY INDUSTRIAL AREA

Vizag - Chennai Industrial Corridor - Kadapa
A US\$ 1.07 Billion (Rs.8,860 Cr) Greenfield Investment Opportunity in South India



- 2,550.65 Acres
- 8,860 Cr. Investment Potential
- 54,500 Jobs

Total Saleable Area - 1403.5 (Acres)

Industrial	Commercial	Residential
1213.47	53.78	136.25

Industrial Sale Value 1.25 Cr./Acre

Focus Sectors: Renewables, Auto Components, Metallic Minerals, Non-Metallic Minerals, Textiles, Chemicals & Engineering Goods.

Anchor Investor Discount up to 25% available on Industrial Area. For details on land allotment policies, please visit www.apicdc.in

Changemaker of the Year 2026
Purnima Devi Barman

Conservationist Purnima Devi Barman’s lifelong, passionate work helped bring the Greater Adjutant Stork back from the brink of extinction. She painstakingly put together the ‘Hargila Army’, a 20,000-woman movement in Assam, which helped in the conservation of the endangered bird. By bringing together conservation, cultural traditions, religious celebrations and local crafts, she won over hostile villagers, who then willingly evolved into protective guardians. Her effort moved the species’ status on the IUCN Red List from ‘Endangered’ to ‘Near Threatened’ in 2023. Beyond wildlife protection, her movement turned rural women into self-reliant artisans and entrepreneurs, generating steady income through stork-themed traditional textiles and crafts. She aims to scale her conservation model to 5,000 storks by 2035 across India and Cambodia.



Presents



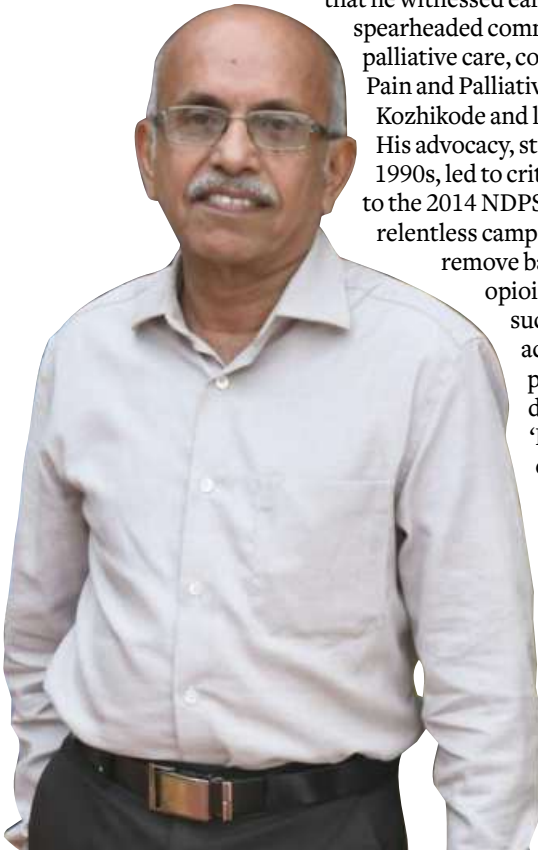
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AND THE WINNERS ARE...

ICONIC Changemaker
Dr MR Rajagopal

Palliative care pioneer Dr MR Rajagopal has dedicated himself for over four decades and more to easing human suffering and transforming India’s approach towards incurable illnesses. Deeply affected by unaddressed cancer pain that he witnessed early in his career, he spearheaded community-focussed palliative care, co-founding the Pain and Palliative Care Society in Kozhikode and later Pallium India. His advocacy, starting in the early 1990s, led to critical amendments to the 2014 NDPS Act. His relentless campaign helped remove barriers to essential opioid medication, such as morphine, across India. He pioneered the decentralised ‘Kerala Model’, ensuring trained nurses in every panchayat, and successfully integrated mandatory palliative care education into MBBS and nursing curricula nationwide.



ICONIC Changemaker
Border Roads Organisation

The Border Roads Organisation (BRO) was recognised for helping modernise strategic infrastructure across 15,000 km of sensitive borderlands. The BRO has built over 64,400 km of roads, 1,000 bridges, 22 airfields and key high-altitude tunnels in some of the toughest terrains. Currently led by Lt Gen Harpal Singh, the agency adopted AI-assisted review systems, LiDAR mapping and digital management tools to compress execution timelines. Beyond military readiness, its projects integrate remote border posts via initiatives like the Vibrant Villages Programme. Additionally, BRO has broken gender barriers by appointing woman officers like Col Sphurti Kulkarni and Col Shikha Bhadauria to field task force commands. Despite modern weapons that can find almost anything on the surface with growing accuracy, the country’s response should not be to stop building – as connectivity remains non-negotiable – but to build depth, redundancy and, where it matters most, protection underground.



Lt General Harpal Singh,
Director General, Border
Roads Organisation

YOUNG Changemaker
Ariana Agarwal

Sixteen-year-old Ariana Agarwal has shown exemplary empathy belying her years. She has helped create the Informal Economy Index (IEI) with an eye on empowering India’s invisible gig and informal workforce. Starting at age 14, after realising that her family driver lacked basic documentation, she built a student-led volunteer framework to map worker vulnerabilities. The IEI collects grassroots data to assign workers a ‘Vulnerability Score’, connecting them directly to social security schemes, bank accounts and financial literacy training. Operating across 8–10 districts in eight States, her platform has reached over 14,000 informal workers. She collaborates with NGOs, financial institutions and district administration officials with a view to not just ensuring benefits become accessible but also to nudge policy for informal labour.



Changemaker FINANCIAL Transformation
Gourmet Popcornica

Gourmet Popcornica has helped revolutionise India’s agricultural value chain through its unique farm-to-consumer model. Managing Director SBP Pattabhi Rama Rao expanded operations from 11 acres and two farmers in 2016 to more than 40,000 acres and 17,800 farmers today. The company is now Asia’s largest popcorn maize producer. The company offers fixed pricing to farmers ahead of the season, guarantees procurement of 100 per cent of crops and supplies inputs such as seeds and fertilizers via interest-free credit. It has helped farmers escape the clutches of moneylenders, with their income rising about 40 per cent on average. Operating transparently with contracts in local languages and direct WhatsApp financial updates, Gourmet Popcornica has provided financial stability, interest-free financing and derisking opportunities to smallholder farmers across Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Chhattisgarh.



SBP Pattabhi Rama Rao, Managing
Director, Gourmet Popcornica

Changemaker DIGITAL Transformation
ARMMAN

Founded by Dr Aparna Hegde, ARMMAN uses mobile technology, field networks and artificial intelligence to strengthen maternal and child healthcare across India. After identifying gaps in primary care, the organisation helped develop scalable mobile-health solutions to ensure that relevant information reaches mothers and to equip auxiliary nurse midwives with real-time, clinically sound guidance. ARMMAN’s tech-enabled interventions offer personalised health instruction, allowing for early identification of high-risk pregnancies and timely referrals. By training over 5,50,000 frontline health workers and reaching millions of pregnant women, ARMMAN’s efforts help reduce maternal and infant mortality. Combining digital innovation with a ‘tech plus touch’ approach, the non-profit encouraged health-seeking behaviour and bridged crucial healthcare gaps in underserved communities that struggled with either lack of awareness or lack of access, or in the worst case, both.



Gaurav Shah, CEO,
ARMMAN

Changemaker SOCIAL Transformation
Project Sambandh

A brainchild of Colonel Vembu Shankar, Project Sambandh provides critical support to families of armed forces personnel who die under non-combat circumstances, such as illness or accidents. Survivors of battle casualties tend to receive institutionalised welfare and may even receive higher pension than personnel who die due to non-combat reasons. The latter case often leaves surviving kin facing bureaucratic hurdles and lack of awareness of benefits due to them. Project Sambandh maps these families, particularly young widows and children, and bridges connections with military authorities, regimental centres and government bodies. Having reached over 27,000 survivors, the initiative has helped them secure pending pensions, accessing educational grants and navigating welfare schemes.



Colonel Vembu
Shankar

Changemaker SOCIAL Transformation
Sankara Eye Foundation India

Established by Dr RV Ramani and Dr Radha Ramani in the 1970s, Sankara Eye Foundation is dedicated to eradicating preventable blindness through quality, accessible eyecare. Through its rural outreach initiatives, such as the ‘Gift of Vision’ programme, the organisation conducts door-to-door screenings and brings patients to modern surgical facilities. Operating a nationwide network of eye hospitals, the Foundation follows a sustainable 80:20 cross-subsidy model, where revenue from paying patients help subsidise entirely free surgeries and treatment for the economically backward classes of society. Having screened millions and performed lakhs of surgeries with assembly-line precision, the Sankara Eye Foundation’s approach has shown how compassionate healthcare can operate at scale without compromising on excellence.



Dr RV Ramani, Founder and
Managing Trustee, Sankara
Eye Foundation India

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How Purnima Barman’s Hargila Army gave wings to the stork

THE WINNING SECRET. Community, culture sit at the heart of her unconventional conservation movement

Chitra Narayanan
New Delhi

“When women rise, magic happens, and the Hargila takes flight,” said Purnima Devi Barman, the *businessline* Changemaker of 2026, as she accepted the award to a thunderous applause.

In a heart-warming moment, the conservationist from Assam who has saved the endangered Greater Adjutant Stork (Hargila), asked the audience to move their hands in an action reminiscent of a bird flapping its wings – a spontaneous call that touched and stirred the audience.

PASSION TO FASHION

Community and culture sit at the heart of Barman’s unconventional conservation movement that has saved the Hargila, and at the same time, empowered village women to become self-reliant entrepreneurs. Barman did not let resistance and hostility faze her as she set out to save the rare and imposing bird that is nearly five feet tall and has an impressive eight-foot wingspan.

She wooed and won over villagers by introducing the bird in their rituals and pujas, organising baby showers for stork mothers, and has since mobilised over 20,000 village women for her Hargila Army that



protects the bird. Barman also trained the stork sisterhood in traditional arts and crafts and helped them weave change in their own lives by becoming financially independent. Many of them earn over ₹60,000 per month.

The *mekhela chador* (a traditional two-piece attire) some of them wove now graces the National History Museum, London.

“Our passion has become fashion,” said Barman, showing the stork pendant and earrings she was wearing and the stork motif embroidered on her outfit. “For generations, people thought the stork was a harbinger of bad omen. But she is now flying in my *mekhela chador*, in my neck piece, in my heart. I want to spread the movement, to save the



bird, to save nature and save the planet,” she said.

TRACING THE ROOTS

The roots of this save-the-stork movement trace back to 2002 when she was planning her PhD on the stork species. “But, then, I got married, had kids and I had a mountain of responsibilities as a new mother and daughter-in-law,” she said.

That did not stop her from studying the bird, however. When she started her research, there were just 13 active nests in Kamrup district of Assam and barely 450 birds in the State.

Today, there are 322 nests in Kamrup and almost 2,000 of these birds in Assam.

“Conservation and livelihood go hand-in-hand. It gives me hope when women convert from home-makers to conservationists and entrepreneurs,” said Barman, saying her goal was to take the Hargila population to 5,000 in the next 10 years.

From ‘invisible’ to ‘included’: Elevating the informal worker

Our Bureau
New Delhi

At just 16, Jaipur-based changemaker Ariana Agarwal has been recognised for her work to improve the lives of India’s informal workers, receiving the *businessline* Young Changemaker Award 2026 from Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman in New Delhi on Tuesday.

The Young Changemaker award celebrates an individual below 30 years of age.



Ariana Agarwal

THE JOURNEY

Agarwal’s journey towards bringing about societal change began when she was just a Class 8 student. She noticed that her family’s driver, whom she had known since childhood, did not know his date of birth, did not have a birth certificate and had never seen his Aadhaar card.

“That fact just scared me,” she recalled, saying the experience made her realise how deeply invisibility affected India’s informal workforce.

She began researching issues such as social security, debt and financial literacy, conducting surveys and studying the difficulties faced by informal and gig workers. In June 2024, at the age of 14, she launched the Informal Economy Index (IEI), bringing together volunteers to survey workers and identify their most pressing challenges.

The IEI developed a “vulnerability score” that assesses factors including debt, migration, financial inclusion and access to social

protection. Based on the findings, workers are connected with relevant government schemes, financial literacy programmes, debt-management guidance and local support systems. Data is also collated district-wise and State-wise and shared with NGOs and government organisations to support more informed decision-making.

‘A SEAT AT THE TABLE’

The initiative has directly reached more than 14,000 informal workers across eight to 10 districts in eight States. It has also worked with organisations including Punjab National Bank and ACORN Foundation India. Agarwal said the initiative’s larger goal is for institutions to independently adopt and replicate the model.

“I am so happy to win this award as it gives youngsters a seat at the table. It is a strong motivation to work towards achieving the targets set,” she said.

With support from the International Baccalaureate’s Festival of Hope grant, IEI now aims to reach 40,000 workers by the year-end.

‘BRO’s role goes long beyond roads’

Our Bureau
New Delhi

“When we make roads, we change the way the country defends its borders. When we make roads, we change the way the community lives. When we make the roads, we change the way the people live their livelihood,” Lt Gen Harpal Singh, Director-General of the Border Roads Organisation (BRO), said after accepting *businessline*’s Iconic Changemaker Award on Tuesday.

Singh said he accepts the award with “great humility and gratitude”, but at the same time, he emphasised that the honour actually belonged to the people of his organisation who’ve been toiling for 60 years.

He also expressed his gratitude to *businessline* for recognising the BRO’s timeless work in challenging times. “We are making change for the last 60 years, and I’m happy that in 2026, it has been recognised in a most befit-



Lt General Harpal Singh, Director General, Border Roads Organisation

ting manner, right?” he said in his acceptance remark.

The DG gave a glimpse of the sweat and toil his workforce goes through routinely to ensure the defence forces’ strategic mobility is seamless.

“And I dare say that we have changed the complexion of this country by making roads to the border where none existed... We have people who have the nerves of steel as they dare to go places where no one can ever imagine going,” he said to ap-

Providing support for bereaved military families

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Project Sambandh, which helps bereaved families of armed forces personnel access welfare benefits and financial assistance, has won the *businessline* Changemaker Award for Social Transformation.

Led by Colonel Vembu Shankar, the initiative focusses on families of personnel who die while in service due to non-combat causes. His interventions have helped 27,000 people, including widows seeking livelihoods and children pursuing education.

CHALLENGES APLENTY

Speaking after accepting the award, Shankar said about 1,500 armed forces personnel die every year in non-operational circumstances, leaving their families facing challenges that extend beyond the immediate loss. “It could be financial challenges, it could be social challenges, it could



Colonel Vembu Shankar

be emotional challenges,” he said.

While the armed forces and society come forward to assist at the time of death, gaps in support emerge over the years, he said. Project Sambandh seeks to address these gaps by maintaining contact with families and helping them access assistance.

Shankar said he travels 15-20 days a month to reach families in remote

plause from the audience.

The BRO cuts roads every day throughout the year, even in areas where the temperature drops to minus (as much as minus 30 at times) with barely any oxygen, he said. “Survival is difficult, but we live and work to make a difference to this country.”

NATION-BUILDING

Dwelling into the BRO’s contribution to nation building, Singh said that the development truly happens when the road reaches the last mile.

The BRO has made 64,000 km long roads, which he said was not a simple number. This was achieved with a strength of just about 30,000 workforce deployed in different parts the country, he said. According to him, the organisation is more than just roads, steel and bridges.

He also said the BRO’s ₹20,000 crore budgetary allocation for this fiscal is enough to meet the strategic infrastructure requirements spiralling due to regional insecurities.

areas. He acknowledged the support of his family and the armed forces in carrying out the work.

Thanking The Hindu Group, *businessline* and the jury, he appealed for greater awareness of the difficulties faced by these families and support for the initiative.

Project Sambandh identifies families through armed forces databases, referrals and Shankar’s network. Each case is verified to establish whether the death occurred during service and whether the family needs assistance. Subsequently, the family’s requirements are matched with available schemes.

Support includes filling out forms, collecting documents, identifying the appropriate authorities and following up on applications.

Shankar carries out the work without a formal NGO, spending nearly a third of his pension on the effort. Having taken an early retirement in 2017, he now wants such support to be institutionalised.

Providing pain relief, dignity in suffering, and not being left alone

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Pallium India Founder Dr MR Rajagopal won *businessline*’s Iconic Changemaker Award 2026 for his contribution to expanding palliative care and integrating relief from suffering into health-care. The award was received on his behalf by Poonam Bagai, V-C, Pallium India, and Founder Chairman of CanKids, who credited him with transforming India’s and the world’s understanding of suffering and the collective responsibility to relieve it.

HEALING ONESELF

An anaesthesiologist, Rajagopal has worked for decades to bring physical, social, mental and spiritual well-being into patient care, alongside the diagnosis and treatment of disease.

Accepting the award, Bagai recalled meeting Rajagopal more than two decades ago and learning from him about palliative care.

Recounting her own experience with cancer, she said while doctors focused on curing the disease, she had learnt to focus on healing herself. Listening to Rajagopal subsequently helped



Poonam Bagai, V-C, Pallium India

her understand the role of palliative care in addressing such needs.

She described his work as providing relief from pain, dignity in suffering and the assurance that people need not face serious illness alone.

Besides, Bagai highlighted his contribution to policy reforms, research, education and outreach, alongside the wider community’s efforts to integrate palliative care into healthcare.

THE CONTRIBUTION

Rajagopal founded Pallium India in 2003 to advance this integration across the country. Earlier, in 1993, he had, along with others, estab-

lished the Pain and Palliative Care Society at the Medical College in Kozhikode.

The initiative combined medical services with community participation. Volunteers connected patients with the medical system, made regular visits and helped arrange financial assistance where required.

Subsequently, Rajagopal was instrumental in shaping Kerala’s Palliative Care Policy in 2008. The policy supported a decentralised system involving trained palliative care nurses at the *panchayat* level.

He also led the development of the National Standards for Palliative Care and contributed to the establishment of the National Programme for Palliative Care in 2012.

Another area of intervention was access to essential pain-relief medicines. His sustained advocacy contributed to the 2014 amendment to the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, which helped improve legal access to morphine.

Through Pallium India, training programmes and virtual modules have reached doctors, nurses, volunteers and caregivers across 59 cities.

Taking digital route to transforming healthcare

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Advancing Reduction in Mortality and Morbidity of Mothers, Children and Neonates (ARMMAN), which has saved millions of women through WhatsApp and chatbots, won the *businessline* Changemaker Award in the Digital Transformation category.

Started by Dr Arpana Hegde, Armmman has built its Integrated High-Risk Pregnancy Tracking Management (IHRPTM) programme that works with health workers and doctors to identify and manage high-risk conditions among pregnant women.



Gaurav Shah, CEO, ARMMAN

FURTHER INNOVATION

Solutions were built on the government’s primary health resources already available in the country, such as ASHA or community health workers who had mobile phones. So, they were sent information and trained to diagnose risk factors in time and bring them into the primary care referral pathway – so that only complicated cases went to tertiary hospitals.

The organisation is look-

ing to build scalable and cost-effective solutions and intends to further innovate — using AI, partnerships and mobile technology — to deliver personalised, preventive care at scale.

Receiving the *businessline* Changemaker award, Gaurav Shah, Chief Executive Officer, ARMMAN, said, “Thirty-million pregnancies happen every year in India and of that one-third are high risk conditions... We adopt a unique ‘tech plus touch’ model that combines the deep mobile phone penetration and existing infrastructure of government and NGO partners to inform women and to train health workers, in 27 States and Union Territories.”

Through the *businessline* Changemaker Award, the organisation hopes to see more such initiatives coming from other start-ups, he added.

A simple, stubborn idea: To make world-class popcorn

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Chennai-based Gourmet Popcornica won the Changemaker Financial Transformation Award in the 8th edition of the Awards.

Founded in 2014, the company has gone all out to build the country’s popcorn value chain, from hybrid seed and farmer partnerships to kernel processing, storage, supply to cinema halls and branded retail products.

The company has initiated growing popcorn maize domestically that has also helped bring down its imports from 70 per cent of India’s demand a decade ago to 15 per cent currently, even as domestic production has more than doubled.

SBP Pattabhi Rama Rao, MD, Gourmet Popcornica, said, “We did not have a grand plan to become the fifth largest in the world. We had a simple, stubborn idea: Indian farmers can grow world-class popcorn if they had quality seeds, economic guidance, assured procurement price and payments directly hitting their bank accounts.” He added there are



SBP Pattabhi Rama Rao, MD, Gourmet Popcornica

17,500 farmers who are part of Gourmet, spread across eight States, 40,000 acres and 60,000 tonnes of production.

MARKET GROWTH

“We are proud to state that one in two popcorn kernels consumed anywhere in India today is the Andhra popcorn... it is the improvement in the quality of life of farmers that has worked with us. It is a fact that today every Popcornica farmer has an assured contract before a single seed has been planted, a first for Indian agriculture in a commercial crop,” he said. With the steady expansion of maize cultivation for popcorn, the market size has nearly tripled to 1.3 lakh tonnes, Rao added.

Transforming eye care by not turning a blind eye to blindness

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

Sankara Eye Foundation India was on Tuesday recognised with the *businessline* Changemaker Award 2026 in the Social Transformation category for its contribution to making quality eye-care accessible to people, particularly those who cannot afford it.

Dr RV Ramani, Founder and Managing Trustee of Sankara Eye Foundation, described this journey in healthcare as having been inspired by his father, Dr Ramanathan, one of the first three doctors in Coimbatore who began practising in 1941.

After his father’s death, Ramani and his wife, Dr Radha, started a memorial clinic in his name in

1972. Five years later, at the age of 29, Ramani brought together young doctors and volunteers to establish a primary healthcare centre for the needy in Coimbatore, driven by the belief that healthcare is a fundamental human right.

The initiative expanded rapidly, with doctors volunteering their services. By the late 1970s and 1980s, eye-care became its central focus. The Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Medical Trust, established in 1981, became the institutional home for the initiative.

AFFORDABLE EYE CARE

Sankara began rural eye-care outreach in 1987 through its ‘Gift of Vision’ programme, followed by school screening programmes. Its school initiative has since



Dr RV Ramani, Founder, Sankara Eye Foundation

screened more than six million students. Today, the organisation operates 14 hospitals across 10

States and has reportedly treated more than 2.47 crore patients and performed over 35 lakh surgeries.

Its model combines paying patients with free treatment for those unable to afford care. Sankara also conducts rural eye camps, provides free surgeries and operates village vision centres linked to its hospitals.

Accepting the award, Ramani said the organisation began 50 years ago with a single goal that was “to create a world-class eye care hospital with a social impact. Whatever may be the cause, to be blind is not fair if it can be either prevented or cured with quality eye care,” he said.

TRANSFORMATIVE CHANGE

Ramani described the impact of restoring sight as a form of trans-

formative change. He said giving sight to a child could mean 80-90 years of productive life, while restoring an adult’s vision could make them the breadwinner of a family.

“For elderly people, regaining sight could help them remain independent,” he said.

Ramani recalled a 1996 case of a two-year-old boy named Michael, who underwent treatment for corneal opacity in both eyes. Ramani said seeing the child respond to light and movement for the first time was an experience that could not be measured in monetary terms.

Thanking the jury for the award, Ramani said it would be a morale booster for Sankara’s nearly 4,000-member team, encouraging it to “scale greater heights”.

Kharif concerns

Poor rain, acreage may impact rice, water situation

The effects of a 15 per cent deficient monsoon this year — akin to 2002 and 2009 — alongside a drop in acreage this kharif are already becoming evident. While retail food inflation is ruling at 6 per cent, this newspaper recently reported a 50 per increase in prices of fine and superfine varieties of rice in southern States. There has been a generalised rise in rice prices as well.



But there is another side to this retail price hike, which is of farmers not necessarily benefiting as much as traders when output is impacted. Wholesale food prices in August were up 5.67 per cent, lower than the overall WPI rise of nearly 10 per cent. Another report in this newspaper points to moong produce in Rajasthan not fetching good prices. Market prices of pulses and oilseeds in particular often tend to rule below MSP. Therefore, the Centre and States may have to brace for a dual situation of food inflation and farm stress. A combination of untimely rain and moisture stress may have affected the tur crop in Karnataka. Market analysts expect a paddy output drop of at least 10 million tonnes over last kharif’s 124.5 mt. There are some short-term and long-term policy issues that arise from this situation of crop and water shortfall. With reservoir levels well below the norm, the Centre and States must draw up a plan for drought relief and water use with an eye on rabi requirements, while also considering curbs on industry and the urban sector.

Paddy acreage for the country as a whole was down over 16 lakh hectares to 427 lakh hectares, with Karnataka and Telangana accounting for over half this fall. This drop corresponds with the 21-43 per cent failure of the monsoon in the five southern States, way above the national average. Punjab and Haryana have recorded a shortfall of 39 per cent and 22 per cent, respectively, which may impact their paddy output, notwithstanding their irrigation coverage. Groundwater stress is likely to have increased everywhere. To be sure, a rice buffer stock of 60 million tonnes implies that a dip in output is no cause for alarm on the food security front. Some of these stocks can be released as the festival season demand picks up. It is also worth considering whether an allocation of 7.2 mt of broken rice as ethanol feedstock should be reduced in times such as these.

According to the All India Distillers’ Association, maize (46 per cent) and FCI rice (22 per cent) account for most of the ethanol feedstock. While maize manages with less water, a price spike impacts the animal feed industry, which is a competing user. Ethanol demand can create imbalances, and the blending norm should perhaps be revisited in such times. Lower paddy output this year should not be taken to mean that diversifying away from rice is a bad idea. Rice buffer stocks of, say, 40 mt are ample to deal with severe shocks. Millets should be pushed from the supply and demand side, and paddy grown with less water and inputs.

POCKET RAVIKANTH



In 1953, Bengaluru had a factory that produced almost nothing that people could use directly. Hindustan Machine Tools, or HMT, was established with a deceptively ambitious purpose. It would manufacture the ‘mother machines’ needed to build a modern industrial India. Lathes, milling machines and gear shapers were not products most Indians needed to buy — they were the machines for industrial production.

And then came watches. In 1961, HMT established the first watch factory in Bengaluru with Japanese watchmaker Citizen. It had to absorb the technology of mass-producing microscopic components. By 1975, the factory was making mainsprings, hairsprings and shock absorbers in-house, giving it control over the entire process.

The machine tools taught India to make machines with precision; watchmaking pushed that precision into a much smaller world. The industry changed. The discipline did not.

Capability rarely travels in a straight line, moving through people, suppliers, apprenticeships and manufacturing culture, rather than documented lineage. What HMT helped establish was more durable: the idea that precision could become transferable. That capability is visible today across India’s manufacturing ecosystem, in specialised materials, aerospace, defence and advanced engineering, accumulated and recombined, rather than passed down in an unbroken line.

Titan took the opposite route: its precision-engineering arm grew out of watchmaking, and now builds machine tools and aerospace and defence components. The direction hardly matters; the discipline does.

Ethereal Machines, based in Bengaluru, is an instructive example. Founded in 2014 by college classmates Kaushik Mudda and Navin Jain to make more precisely cut parts for their own projects, it went on to build indigenous multi-axis CNC platforms, winning a CES Best of Innovation award in 2018. It now runs a machining-as-a-service model for aerospace, medical devices and electronics.

Mudda observes: “My conviction has always been that India has never lacked the engineering talent for advanced manufacturing, only the industrial capability to match it. Ethereal exists to close that gap.” Accurate Engineering Company in Pune illustrates the complementary capability of precision measurement.

Established in 1963 by the late Vilasrao Salunkhe to manufacture measuring instruments and gauges, it built decades of expertise in dimensional metrology. Under his son, Vikram, the MD, that legacy continues into digital, shop-floor measurement systems. Salunkhe emphasises: “AI



Precision is sharpening Indian manufacturing

ROAD TO INNOVATION. India does not need to be good at everything; it needs to become exceptionally good at capabilities the world finds hard to substitute

cannot predict what the factory has never connected. The real promise of AI in precision engineering is not better inspection. It is a factory that increasingly knows the quality of what it is making before the inspection room has to tell it.” This is capability migration. Over time it compounds.

It is worth being precise about what precision actually means. Often reduced to a tight tolerance on a drawing, precision understates what a company has really learned when it can repeatedly manufacture a demanding component.

It has learned to control a process end to end, qualifying suppliers, managing variation and documenting every step: organisational capabilities that take years to build and only months to redeploy once embedded.

A precision manufacturer is, therefore, not merely selling a component; it is selling confidence that the component will be right, every time. That matters as India moves into aerospace, semiconductor equipment and medical devices where failure is unacceptable.

Precision itself is no longer a static discipline. For decades, it meant holding a tolerance and proving it through inspection. AI and digital sensing are shifting that towards prediction: software that flags a process drifting out of specification before a defective part is made. Ethereal’s shift to machining-as-a-service and Accurate’s

A precision manufacturer is not merely selling a component; it is selling confidence that the component will be right

move into digital, shop-floor measurement are early signs of this. Companies that treat precision as fixed, once earned and simply maintained, may find a purely mechanical definition of the term no longer sufficient to compete.

India’s first manufacturing story was written in the language of cost. That story is not finished, but it is no longer sufficient: the more interesting transition underway is from cost to trust. A global customer does not place a demanding, failure-intolerant component with a supplier merely because it is cheap, but because the supplier has proven, audit after audit, that it can deliver the same result under pressure with traceability and consistency.

Trust, therefore, is not a soft attribute, but an industrial capability, measurable through qualification cycles, audits and how much responsibility a customer transfers to a supplier. There is, however, a warning here: India cannot become merely the world’s precision-machining workshop; precision must become a bridge to innovation.

Indian auto component companies remain markedly less R&D-intensive than global peers, a recent Goldman Sachs analysis notes. Government data put India’s R&D spend at just 0.83 per cent of GDP in 2023-24, well below the 2-4.5 per cent typical of innovation-led economies, though the private industry’s share crossed 50 per cent for the first time that year.

Indian companies must continuously renew their capabilities through R&D, tooling and digital manufacturing, not simply deploy them efficiently. The ambition cannot be to make someone else’s component more cheaply; it must eventually be to own the process and

help define the next generation of the product.

That is where manufacturing capability becomes technological capability and technological capability becomes strategic capability.

We tend to ask which sectors India should promote next — aerospace, semiconductors, defence or electronics. The more fundamental question is which capabilities India should deliberately accumulate, knowing they may outlive whichever sector happens to be relevant when they are built.

Precision is one such capability, alongside metrology, tooling, systems engineering and process automation. None of them respect industry boundaries; they can be recombined. A country does not become industrially sophisticated by having factories in many sectors, but when capabilities developed in one make it easier to enter the next.

HMT’s mother machines were built to make the machines that would build a modern India. Decades later, precision capabilities developed in automotive, watchmaking, machining and metrology are finding applications in aerospace, defence and semiconductor equipment. The products and the industries will continue to change; what matters is whether the capabilities beneath them continue to deepen.

India does not need to be good at everything; it needs to become exceptionally good at capabilities the world finds hard to substitute and transfer them faster than others.

Vipin Sondhi is an Independent Director and Former MD & CEO of Ashok Leyland and JCB India; G Sundararaman is the Chief Scientist and Head of Wipro Research. Views expressed are personal

Why it’s time to scrap dollar billing for local SEZ deals

Rupee billing could give information technology firms another reason to stay in India’s special economic zones

P Saravanan
A Paul Williams

India’s special economic zones were built on a simple export logic: transactions with a customer outside the zone, in the domestic tariff area (DTA), must earn foreign exchange for the country. That rule still applies to services, even though it was relaxed for goods long ago. A software company, or a defence contractor sitting inside an SEZ, selling to an Indian client a few kilometres away in the same city, is currently required to bill that client in dollars.

The Indian buyer must first purchase foreign currency from an authorised dealer bank, paying a commission, and the SEZ unit must then convert those dollars back into rupees, paying another commission, for a transaction that never actually leaves the country. Public sector undertakings in defence, space and aerospace, which rely on specialised maintenance and engineering services from SEZ-based firms, have complained

for years that this pushes up costs without any benefit to the exchequer.

The Commerce Department has circulated a draft Cabinet note, proposing an amendment to Section 2(z) of the SEZ Act, 2005, the provision that governs how services must be paid for. The change would allow SEZ units to receive rupee payments for services rendered to DTA customers, bringing services in line with the treatment already available for goods. Officials are also working to align the statutory definition of a service with the one used under the Goods and Services Tax law.

The sectors expected to benefit the most are IT, IT-enabled services, defence, aerospace, engineering, maintenance, and repair and overhaul work, where an Indian unit can often complete a task in about a week, compared with over a year for a foreign vendor. If cleared, the amendment removes the pain point for the services sector and makes SEZ units more attractive to local vendors, particularly



A REVERSAL. Rupee gains currency

for government departments reluctant to handle the paperwork and costs of foreign-currency billing. It also arrives at a moment when several IT firms have been reconsidering their SEZ presence following the withdrawal of earlier Income Tax incentives, so rupee billing could be one more reason to stay put.

Loosening the foreign exchange requirement for services, without an equally tight definition of what constitutes a domestic transaction, risks blurring the line that regulators have historically guarded closely. How tightly the final rules are drawn will depend on the balance between a Commerce

Ministry keen on ease of doing business and a Finance Ministry watchful of revenue leakage.

A harmonised definition of services across the SEZ Act and the GST law is the right starting point, paired with sector-specific guidance, since the needs of a defence contractor billing a public sector client are not the same as those of an IT firm billing a private one. The RBI and authorised dealer banks will need a clear operating framework for rupee settlement so that banks are not left to interpret an ambiguous rule on their own.

This amendment need not be seen only as a narrow fix to a billing anomaly. It could be a first step towards a broader rethink of how SEZs, designed for a world of export-led growth, now fit into an economy where the domestic market is often the bigger opportunity.

Saravanan is Professor of Finance and Accounting at IIM-Tiruchirappalli; Williams is the Head of India at Sernova Financial

LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Insurance for all
Apropos ‘Time to Reset the Indian Insurance Industry’ (Sept 22). India’s insurance industry needs a decisive reset, from premium-driven expansion to customer-centric protection. Wider penetration must go hand in hand with affordable premiums, transparent products and faster, hassle-free claim settlements. Digitalisation and greater foreign investment can bring capital and innovation, but stronger regulatory oversight is essential to protect policyholders. The focus should also shift towards underserved rural households and the missing middle.

A competitive, transparent and technology-enabled insurance ecosystem is vital for achieving insurance for all.
NR Nagarajan
Sivakasi, TN

Slippery trade ties
This is with reference to the article ‘Graham Bill’s Strange Timing’ (Sept 22). The US Russia sanctions Bill could impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on major Russian energy buyers, creating implications for India’s crude imports. If India faces punitive tariffs, or significantly reduces oil purchases from Russia, it may need

to source additional crude from other markets. India’s high import dependence and higher international crude prices could increase the country’s import bill and domestic inflationary pressures. India and US had strained ties last year when Trump imposed an additional 25 per cent tariff on India for the import of Russian crude. Now, at this crucial time, India has decided to take necessary measures to protect its trade and economic interests and work with trade and industry bodies to address the consequences of the legislation by the United States. It is a hugely

welcome move by the nation.
P Victor Selvaraj
Palayamkottai, TN

Fair taxing of data centres
Apropos ‘Data Centres Must be Taxed Properly’ (Sept 22). India’s 20-year tax holiday for data centres is a puzzling concession. These facilities consume enormous amounts of electricity and water while generating substantial profits for global technology companies. Treating them as complementary goods deserving exemption ignores the basic principle that what adds value should also contribute to the

public exchequer. The current approach subsidises foreign companies at the expense of Indian taxpayers. A more sensible policy would involve taxing data centres appropriately, while offering incentives for renewable energy use, water recycling and local job creation. The revenue generated could fund digital infrastructure for rural India. Tax holidays must serve national interest, not corporate convenience. Fair taxation of data centres is not hostility to technology, but simple economic prudence.
K Chidanand Kumar
Bengaluru

Easing funding for co-ops

New Bill broadens NCDC’s financing role

S Dharmaraj

The NCDC Amendment Bill, 2026 seeks to update the institutional and financial framework of the National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) in line with the changing requirements of India’s cooperative sector. One of its significant features is the widening of institutional channels for cooperative development.

Many organisations supporting cooperatives are not themselves registered as cooperative societies, and under the existing framework NCDC may face limitations in directly financing such institutions even when their activities substantially benefit cooperatives. The proposed provision enabling NCDC to finance “any entity engaged in cooperative development”, subject to prescribed conditions, can address this institutional gap and facilitate a wider ecosystem involving infrastructure providers, technology institutions, processing organisations, marketing agencies and other specialised entities.

The Bill also seeks to facilitate faster and more direct financial assistance by permitting NCDC to provide loans and grants directly to eligible entities engaged in cooperative development. This could reduce procedural delays and support time-sensitive projects relating to technology, infrastructure, processing, storage, market linkages and value-chain development. Greater flexibility in financing is particularly relevant as cooperatives are increasingly diversifying into processing, branding, logistics, digital services, marketing and other modern business activities.

SHARE CAPITAL
Another important proposal is to permit NCDC, with the Centre’s approval, to participate in the share capital of cooperative societies or entities engaged in cooperative development. This can potentially strengthen the capital base of institutions that require long-term financial support beyond conventional borrowing. However, equity participation also exposes public funds to investment and business risks, making due diligence, valuation, investment limits, risk assessment, performance monitoring and appropriate exit mechanisms important. The proposed expansion of



CO-OPS. Financial empowerment

“foodstuffs” to include other food items notified by the Centre, together with removal of the geographical restriction relating to industrial goods, may further facilitate diversification, value addition and greater cooperative participation in modern supply chains.

The offered power to collect and share credit information with the RBI and other notified financial institutions can strengthen credit appraisal, reduce information asymmetry and support more responsible lending and risk management.

At the same time, the wider NCDC mandate raises concerns regarding the potential expansion of beneficiaries beyond cooperative societies. Although the Statement of “Objects and Reasons” indicates that cooperatives will remain the primary beneficiaries, clear eligibility criteria and safeguards are essential to prevent disproportionate diversion of resources to non-cooperative entities.

The framework should also ensure adequate access and priority for PACS and other grassroots cooperatives, which may face capacity constraints.

The implementation framework should therefore clearly define an “entity engaged in cooperative development”, establish objective eligibility criteria, preserve cooperative societies as the primary beneficiaries, provide appropriate priority to grassroots institutions, and prescribe safeguards for equity participation and beneficiary selection. A clear “cooperative-benefit test” would be particularly valuable. The guiding principle should therefore be: wider powers for NCDC, but with stronger safeguards to ensure that cooperative societies and their members remain the primary beneficiaries.

The writer is Director, Institute of Cooperative Management, Madurai

thehindubusinessline. TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

September 23, 2006

Kerala HC quashes ban on Coke and Pepsi

A Division Bench of the Kerala High Court quashed the State Government orders banning the manufacture and sale of Coca-Cola and Pepsi Cola, saying that the Government had no power to pass such orders under the provisions of the Prevention of Food Adulteration Act. The Bench pointed out that if the State Legislature and Parliament had concurrent powers on a matter, the executive power of the State Government was subject to and limited to the executive power of the Central Government.

Buoyant trend continues in exports

Exports continue to be buoyant with proceeds crossing \$10 billion for a single month in August. Cumulatively, exports during April to August are valued at \$48 billion, which is 34.48 per cent higher than the level of \$35.76 billion during in the corresponding months of 2005.

Jet Air allowed to withdraw ₹1,500 cr from escrow a/c

In another victory over Sahara Airlines, Jet Airways was allowed by the Bombay High Court to withdraw the ₹1,500 crore deposited by it in an escrow account with ICICI Bank for acquiring Sahara, against a bank guarantee for the same amount.

Will Pakistan fight for Saudi Arabia?

Houthi missiles are hitting deep inside Saudi Arabia, forcing Islamabad to confront its new collective-security pledge

THE WIDER ANGLE.



PARAN BALAKRISHNAN

Pakistan could hardly have dreamt when it signed the tripartite Makkah Defence Pact that it could be called on to honour its commitments barely six weeks later.

Yemen’s Houthis have emerged much stronger, seizing major stretches of the Red Sea coastline and pushing towards the Bab al-Mandab strait, a crucial shipping chokepoint. Now they’re firing ballistic missiles and attack drones at Saudi Arabia, including attacks on Riyadh and the kingdom’s vital Red Sea oil infrastructure at Yanbu. On Saturday, a missile aimed at Riyadh was intercepted, while a fire erupted near King Khalid International Airport. The Houthis also claimed an attack on an Aramco facility at Yanbu.

Under the Makkah pact, an armed attack on any one of Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkiye is to be seen as an attack on all. The pact was presented as a collective defence arrangement to deter external aggression.

With the ink barely dry, will Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman call on his two new allies to honour the pledge?

For Pakistan, it’s the ultimate tightrope walk. On one side is its defence deal with Saudi Arabia, to which it has long provided training and security help. Defence Minister Khawaja Asif has said an attack on Saudi Arabia could activate it, while military spokesman Lieutenant-General Ahmed Sharif Chaudhry has said Pakistan stands “physically” and diplomatically with Riyadh.

But Pakistan has presented itself as a peacemaker in the wider Middle East conflict. Field Marshal Asim Munir has made numerous trips to Tehran as Islamabad tries to help end the war.

Complicating things is that the Saudis and Iranians are arch-enemies, and Iran has long backed the Houthis.

It puts Pakistan in an awkward position. The Houthis have amassed some 100,000 fighters and captured



TIGHTROPE WALK. Pakistan may be discovering that becoming a regional power-broker can come with a very high price VIA REUTERS

strategic territory around the Red Sea. Pakistan faces the prospect of defending Saudi territory against an Iran-backed movement while simultaneously trying to keep diplomatic channels to Tehran open. The Houthis have become so strong that questions are now being asked about whether Saudi Arabia can withstand the assault.

The oil-rich kingdom was created in 1932, and huge oil reserves were soon discovered. Ibn Saud created the new kingdom by bringing together 22 tribes. Now those tribal links could be under strain from the Houthi onslaught.

When Saudi Arabia was formed, it also seized three territories that had been part of Yemen. On Tuesday, Saudi Arabia issued an alert for Najran province, near the Yemeni border, without specifying why.

Then there’s Mohammed bin Salman, or MBS, the kingdom’s *de facto* ruler

Under the Makkah pact, an armed attack on any one of Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkiye is to be seen as an attack on all

while his father remains king. In 2017, MBS arrested top princes and wealthy businessmen, refusing to release them until they handed over vast sums. Some detainees alleged torture, and the episode left deep resentment. MBS has also seized huge swathes of tribal land for his overweening mega-projects, stoking further anger. Many princes and tribal leaders may hope the ageing king will sideline MBS and choose another prince to rule.

AT ODDS WITH THE UAE

The Saudis are also at odds with the UAE. In Yemen, the two Gulf states have backed different sides, creating mutual ill-will. The UAE is considered closer to Israel. Both Gulf states are playing political games abroad and in the larger region. Saudi Arabia is striving to bring peace to Sudan while the UAE has been accused of interfering in African countries. Algeria recently blocked overflights by Emirati aircraft because it believes the Gulf state is backing Morocco’s claims against Algeria in the Sahel region.

The wider point is that the Gulf is a relatively recent political construct, assembled largely in the first half of the

20th century. These states then relied heavily on the US for military backing and security.

But Washington has made clear it can’t handle another war on top of the Iran conflict. Trump is said to have rejected requests from MBS to bomb the Houthis. The Houthis have therefore managed something once almost impossible: forcing Saudi Arabia to look beyond its American security umbrella towards regional alliances.

Which brings the crisis back to Pakistan. It has just signed a collective security pact with Saudi Arabia and Turkiye while trying to mediate between Iran and the US.

Now the two roles are colliding. If Riyadh asks Pakistan to activate the Makkah pact, Islamabad will have to decide how far it will go in defending Saudi Arabia against the Houthis while maintaining its carefully cultivated ties with Iran, with which Pakistan shares a 400-mile border.

It may be a case of being careful what you wish for. Pakistan has long wanted a larger Middle East role. Now, it may be discovering that becoming a regional power-broker can come with a very high price.

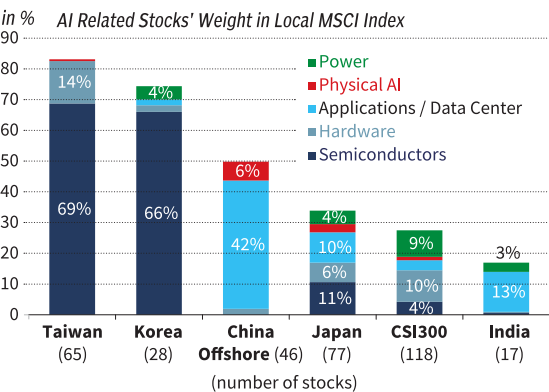
STATISTALK.

Compiled Dhuraveil Gunasekaran | Graphic Visveswaran V

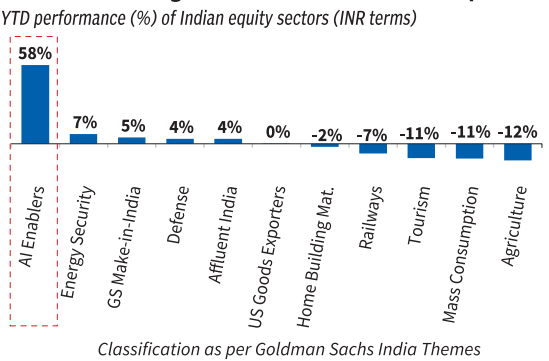
India’s AI opportunity is hiding beneath the index

India has lagged major markets as weaker AI exposure coincided with lower correlation to the global AI theme, highlighting the benchmark’s limited participation in the technology-led rally in recent years. AI-related stocks account for only 16% of MSCI India, well below the exposure seen in Korea, Taiwan, China and Japan. Goldman Sachs identifies 42 AI Enablers across power, data centres and semiconductors, with the cohort up 60% in 2026 even as the Nifty declined 12%. Their exposure is concentrated in power equipment, utilities and technology hardware, while the group spans large, mid, small and micro-cap companies. Key facts:

India’s exposure to AI is below most markets

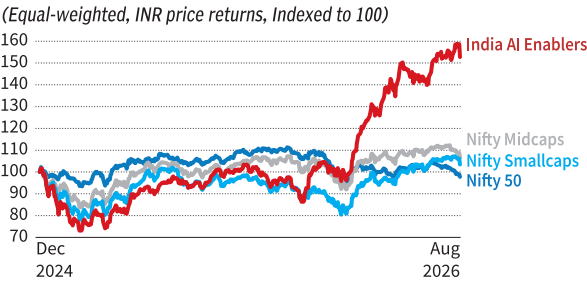


AI Enablers emerge as India’s standout market pocket



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

AI Enablers break sharply away from Nifty

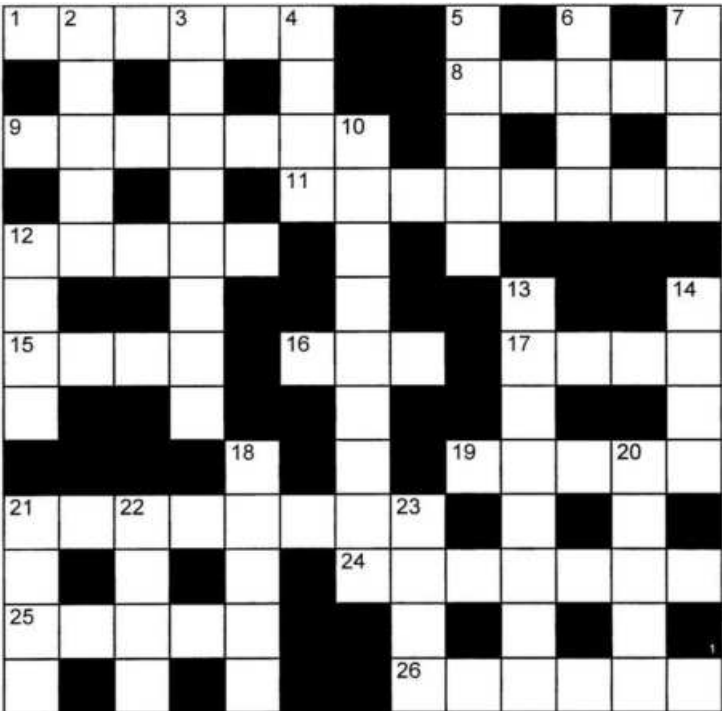


India AI Enablers list

The 42-stock universe spans power, semiconductors and data centres

Power Equipment - ABB - Cummins - Siemens - Hitachi Energy - GE Vernova I&D - APAR - Kirloskar Oil Engines - Schneider Electric - TD Power - MTAR Tech - Diamond Power - Waaree Renewable	Power Generation - Adani Green - Tata Power - NTPC Green - ACME Solar - Clean Max	Power Transmission - Power Grid - Adani Energy - KEC
Semiconductor OSAT - CG Power - Waaree Energies - Sansera - Keynes Tech - Paras Defence	Semiconductor Hw & Materials - Gujarat Fluoro - Navin Fluorine - Himadri - Netweb	
Data Centre Hardware - Polycab - Kel - Sterite Tech - HFCL - Blue Star - Craftsman - Syma SGS	Data Centre Operators & Developers - Reliance - Bharti Airtel - L&T - Adani Ent. - Anant Raj Brigade	

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2741



EASY

ACROSS

- Horse’s fastest pace (6)
- Assembly, market-place (5)
- Tuneful, musical (7)
- Fictitious; sentimental (8)
- Loosely scatter (5)
- Dry sherry (4)
- A bath (3)
- Do as one is told (4)
- Row of bushes (5)
- Mound burrowing animal throws up (8)
- At a previous time (7)
- House walking-surface (5)
- Young Persian (6)

DOWN

- Ward off, turn aside (5)
- A spectator (6-2)
- A couple (4)
- Of a navy (5)
- Twelve-inch measure (4)
- In _____: in full court (4)
- Red or white blood cell (9)
- Yielding to the touch (4)
- A bed-cover (8)
- Cow-house (4)
- A voracious fish (5)
- A diving-bird (5)
- A hand or ear warmer (4)
- Weaver’s machine (4)
- Not to have (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Lively old dance in which leading lady would go full out (6)
- A turn Academician is given in Roman market place (5)
- As tuneful as such old mice can be (7)
- Is sentimentally inclined to cram in a roundabout way (8)
- Scatter the last of the pepper in the ragout (5)
- If no other sort, at least dry sherry is produced (4)
- The container has but to be returned (3)
- Follow orders? One order, at the start of the year (4)
- Lay off bets between one garden and the next, perhaps (5)
- He’ll take limo out and, exaggerating, make a mountain of it (8)
- Farther back in time it was rare lie that was made up (7)
- It’s what one stands on that may have one stumped (5)
- A small feline from Kent, it could be (6)

DOWN

- At holding the parson up will turn it aside (5)
- There’s one watching the lone rook to be moved (6-2)
- There’s two for one, in the allowable number of strokes (4)
- Balaclava never showed up such an architect of shipping (5)
- It is a measure of the infantry (4)
- Prohibition is first conceived by the judges’ bench (4)
- It is possible to credit couples with a bit of blood (9)
- If it’s yielding, it may be apt to fall in price (4)
- One’s disguise is permitted to be like a counterpane (8)
- Where they’re housing cows in the lobby, reputedly (4)
- Nurse such an extortioner as this? (5)
- A diving bird found in the bag rebel is holding (5)
- A bungler may make it to warm his hands (4)
- This may impend, like the shaft of an oar (4)
- There’s a shortage of a great deal of money in India, one is told (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2740

ACROSS 1. Instruments 8. Minister 9. Knar 10. Heeds 13. Rags 16. Soak 17. Zinc 18. Dyke 20. Spots 24. Robe 25. Dilation 26. Undermining

DOWN 2. None 3. Taste 4. Upend 5. Naker 6. Ambassadors 7. Prosecuting 11. Evens 12. Shako 14. Avid 15. Cask 19. Emend 21. Prism 22. Train 23. Lien

QUICKLY.

NSE pays ₹186 crore as fees to 20 banks for IPO



NSE paid about ₹186 crore in fees to the 20 banks that worked on its \$2.4 billion initial public offering, according to an exchange filing. The payout amounts to about 0.82 per cent of the issue size, highlighting the relatively modest fees bankers accepted to advise on one of India's most anticipated IPOs in years. While that was higher than the roughly 0.65 per cent indicated before the offering, it is well below the 1.86 per cent average rate paid by local companies last year, according to data compiled by LSEG. NSE appointed about 20 banks for the offering, with Kotak Mahindra Capital Co, JM Financial, Morgan Stanley, HSBC Holdings Plc, Citigroup Inc and JPMorgan Chase and Co taking key roles. BLOOMBERG

Vedanta Power to join Nifty 500, Smallcap 250

Mumbai: Anil Agarwal-led Vedanta Power will be included in the Nifty 500 and Nifty Smallcap 250 indices from September 30. The company was recently listed on the exchanges following its demerger from Vedanta. The changes will come into effect after the close of trading on September 29. With its inclusion in the Nifty Smallcap 250, Vedanta Power will also become part of the Nifty MidSmallcap 400 and Nifty Smallcap 500 indices. The inclusion will expand the company's representation across widely tracked market benchmarks. However, index inclusion does not automatically translate into additional fund flows or a valuation re-rating, an analyst said. OUR BUREAU

46 stocks, 275 entrants: Why India's market cap definitions need a rethink

PLUGGING THE GAP. Churn in mid-cap indices, rush of IPOs, expanding market call for overhaul of classification

Mahesh Ravidas Nayak Mumbai

India's rapidly expanding equity market is reigniting a debate over whether the country's stock and mutual fund classification framework has outlived its relevance. Market participants, including fund managers, brokers and investment bankers, are increasingly questioning a system that classifies the top 100 listed companies as large-caps, the next 150 as mid-caps and all companies beyond the 250th rank as small-caps.

A senior market expert, on the condition of anonymity, argued that while India's market capitalisation has expanded dramatically over the years, the definition of large-cap stocks remains restricted to the top 100 companies. "How can only 100 stocks be classified as large-

caps when market capitalisation has increased so much? There has to be a threshold defined by size rather than the number of stocks," he said. In his view, market classification should be based on m-cap thresholds instead of a fixed number of stocks.

FREQUENT IN & OUT Meanwhile, a key concern highlighted is the high level of churn within benchmark indices. Sanjeev Prasad, Co-Head & Managing Director at Kotak Institutional Equities, noted that only 46 stocks currently in the Nifty Midcap 150 Index were also part of the benchmark five years ago, spanning FY22 to the first half of FY27. During FY22-26, as many as 275 unique stocks entered or exited the index, while every six-month rebalancing saw 13-18 stocks being added and removed. According to him, frequent changes in index



EXPANDING THE PIE. Classification should be based on market cap thresholds instead of a fixed number of stocks, say experts

constituents, often driven by market narratives and sectoral themes rather than fundamentals, create misleading benchmarks and contribute to what he describes as a "survivorship bias" effect.

Kotak Institutional Equities report estimates that a hypothetical unchanged Nifty Midcap 150 portfolio from April 2021 would have delivered returns of 68 per cent, compared with the re-

ported 116 per cent gain generated by the actual index after periodic reconstitutions. An investment banker said the broader classification framework itself requires an overhaul.

MORE SLABS NEEDED He pointed out that companies with m-cap of around ₹40,000 crore are today categorised as small-caps simply because they fall outside the top 250 stocks by

market value. "India's market needs more than just large-, mid- and small-cap categories. With ₹150-200 crore IPOs now listing on the main board, separate micro-cap and mini-micro-cap segments should be introduced," said market expert Arun Kejriwal. "Instead of three buckets, we should have five or six, while also expanding the large-cap universe as the market grows."

The debate extends beyond labels. Industry executives argue that outdated classifications are concentrating institutional flows in a limited set of stocks, leaving many listed companies outside the investment mainstream.

As India's markets deepen and IPO activity remains strong, pressure is growing for a framework that better reflects the scale and diversity of the equity universe.

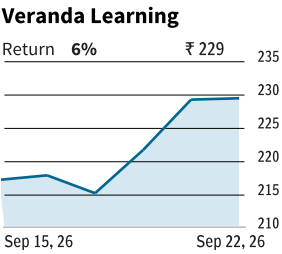
Veranda Learning promoters pledge shares

Our Bureau Chennai

Veranda Learning Solutions said in an exchange filing on Tuesday that its promoters — Kalpathi S Aghoram, Kalpathi S Ganesh, and Kalpathi S Suresh — have executed an unattested pledge agreement with Authum Investment & Infrastructure Ltd for creation of a pledge over equity shares of Veranda Learning held by them.

"The agreement is for ₹111 crore loan availed by the promoters in their personal capacity from the lender, by way of creation of a first-ranking and exclusive pledge over certain equity shares of Veranda Learning held by the promoters," an exchange notification said. It is security for credit facilities availed by them in their personal capacity.

Veranda Learning is not a party to the unattested pledge agreement, the company added. However, Authum is a significant shareholder of the company, holding 10.8 per cent of the



paid-up equity share capital as on September 18 and is therefore a 'related party'.

"The execution of the Un-attested Pledge Agreement does not, by itself, have any impact on the management or control of the company. As is customary in financing arrangements involving a pledge of shares, invocation or enforcement of the pledge by the lender upon the occurrence of events specified in the relevant transaction documents may have a consequential impact on the shareholding pattern of the company. However, such impact would arise only in the event of enforcement in accordance with the agreed terms," Veranda Learning added.

Sensex, Nifty snap winning streak despite easing crude as IT, financials stocks drag

Madhu Balaji Bengaluru

Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower on Tuesday, snapping the Nifty's four-day rally as losses in IT, financial and capital goods stocks outweighed positive global cues and easing crude oil prices.

The BSE Sensex fell 329.91 points to settle at 74,529.08 (touching an intraday low of 74,423.71), while the NSE Nifty declined 85.3 points to end at 23,329. Brent crude, the global oil

benchmark, declined 1.67 per cent to \$98.66 per barrel. "Falling crude oil prices and softer global bond yields offered a more supportive backdrop, but the improvement in global conditions failed to translate into gains for Indian equities. The near-term bias remains cautiously weak, with market direction likely to hinge on whether domestic weakness persists despite an improving global backdrop," said Ponmudi R, CEO of Enrich Money, a SEBI-registered online trading and wealth tech firm. Majority of the sectoral in-

dices ended in negative territory. Media, Realty and Metal were the key gainers, while IT, FMCG and Banking were the major laggards. The broader market also remained subdued, with the Nifty Smallcap 100 declining 0.26 per cent and the Nifty Midcap 100 falling 0.14 per cent. A total of 3,670 stocks were traded on the NSE, of which 1,677 advanced, 1,867 declined and 126 remained unchanged. Foreign Institutional Investors offloaded equities worth about ₹3,810 crore on

Tuesday, according to exchange data.

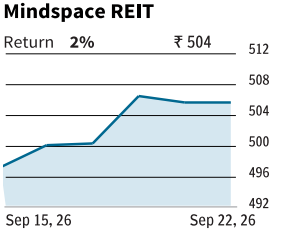
BERNSTEIN ON FPIS Global brokerage Bernstein said foreign institutional investors (FIIs) may continue to trade in Indian equities but have limited reasons to make fresh investments. Sunny Agrawal, Head - Fundamental Research at SBI Securities, said US President Donald Trump is scheduled to deliver his speech at the UN General Assembly on Tuesday, and Dow Futures were trading with gains of 120 points.

Chandru Raheja sells 1.49% stake in Mindspace REIT

Press Trust of India New Delhi

Billionaire Chandru Lachmandas Raheja has divested his holding in Mindspace Business Parks REIT by selling a 1.49 per cent stake for ₹500 crore through a bulk deal on the BSE.

Raheja, Chairman of real estate major K Raheja Corp, sold 99,00,990 units, representing a 1.49 per cent stake in the Mumbai-based REIT, at an average price of ₹505. Details of the buyers of units could not be identified from exchange data.



Mindspace Business Parks REIT, a SEBI-registered real estate investment trust (REIT), has 36 million square feet (msf) of completed area, 6.6 msf under construction area and 3.6 msf future development area.

Aashish Agarwal joins 360 ONE WAM as CEO

Our Bureau Mumbai

Aashish Agarwal, former Managing Director and India Head of Jefferies, has joined 360 ONE WAM Group as CEO, marking a significant leadership transition at the wealth management firm.

Karan Bhagat, currently MD & CEO, will become Vice-Chairman while continuing as MD, focusing on strategy, capital allocation and key client relationships. Yatin Shah will continue to lead wealth management.

SEBI settles proceedings against five Adani firms for ₹1.51 crore

Our Bureau Mumbai



The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has settled adjudication proceedings against five Adani group companies for a combined ₹1.51 crore over alleged disclosure and compliance lapses, including a related-party transaction (RPT) disclosure issue and audit reports signed by firms without valid peer-review certificates.

Adani Enterprises paid ₹76.05 lakh, Adani Green Energy ₹45.50 lakh, while Adani Total Gas, AWL Agri Business and Adani Energy Solutions paid ₹9.75 lakh each.

GOVERNANCE ISSUES

The proceedings stemmed from a SEBI examination into allegations relating to RPT disclosures and corporate governance issues highlighted in the January 2023 Hindenburg Research report. The examination covered seven Adani group companies, including the five that have now settled the matter.

For AEL, SEBI's show-

cause notice alleged that RPTs between Adani Estates, a subsidiary of AEL, and Vakoder Investment, a related party, were not disclosed in the company's FY13 annual report as required under the applicable accounting standard.

The notice also alleged that AEL's audit report for FY15 and limited review report for the June 2015 quarter were signed by Dharmesh Parikh & Co LLP without a valid Peer Review Certificate. Further, its limited review reports for the June and September 2017 and December 2021 quarters were allegedly signed by Shah Dhandharia & Co LLP without a valid certificate.

For Adani Total Gas and AWL Agri Business, SEBI cited their December 2021 limited review reports, which

were allegedly signed by Shah Dhandharia without a valid Peer Review Certificate. For Adani Green, the alleged lapse related to its FY19 audit report and limited review reports for September 2018, December 2018 and June 2019, signed by Dharmesh Parikh. The Adani Energy Solutions proceedings related to its June 2015 limited review report.

SETTLEMENT TIMELINE

The companies proposed settlement in the pending adjudication proceedings in 2024. SEBI's High Powered Advisory Committee recommended the revised terms in June 2026, which were accepted by the Whole-time Members in August. They remitted the amounts in September, after which SEBI disposed of the proceedings.

The settlement comes a year after SEBI dismissed separate allegations concerning certain transactions involving Adani Group firms, while other proceedings arising from the Hindenburg-related examination have been dealt with separately.

Sunil Singhania-led Abakkus Asset Manager files draft papers for IPO

Our Bureau Chennai



Sunil Singhania, Founder, Abakkus Asset Manager

Abakkus Asset Manager Ltd, founded and led by Sunil Banwarilal Singhania, has filed its Draft Red Herring Prospectus (DRHP) with capital markets regulator Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) for its Initial Public Offering (IPO).

This is the second fund house to enter the IPO market after SBI Funds Management that launched its public issue in July raising ₹9,813 crore.

ENTIRELY OFS

The IPO, with a face value of ₹2, is entirely an offer-for-sale for up to 1.50 crore shares by promoter selling shareholder - Abakkus Ex-

BROKER'S CALL.

Jefferies

TBO TEK (BUY)

Target: ₹1,905 CMP: ₹1,703.1

We hosted TBO Tek management at the Jefferies India forum. The management has reiterated confidence in delivering over 20 per cent (CC) Hotel GTV CAGR over the next five years, despite near-term West Asia disruption. Mature KAM cohorts and operating leverage should drive EBITDA growth ahead of GTV. The management noted that periods of disruption tend to increase the importance of service quality and execution, creating opportunities to deepen customer relationships. The company has remained focused on reliability and customer support through the current volatility. The Classic acquisition is expanding TBO's exposure to the large, resilient luxury travel segment, while AI is expected to enhance agent productivity rather than displace the travel-agent model. Currently, TBO inventory is available through Classic, but Classic's inventory is not yet fully integrated onto TBO. It expects front-end integration by CY-end, unlocking meaningful cross-selling opportunities across both platforms. The management estimates that wholesale contributes about 50 per cent of overall GTV, with the balance coming from retail agents. The business is largely API-led and benefits from relatively low customer churn, vs with the inherently higher churn seen in the retail-agent segment. The company has also highlighted that localisation, local-currency payments, reliability and human accountability remain key differentiators of both its API/retail offering, particularly for complex and luxury travel bookings.

UBS

MEESHO (BUY)

Target: ₹260 CMP: ₹240.2

We raise our price target to ₹260 from ₹210 and maintain Buy, reflecting higher medium-term growth estimates and a stronger margin trajectory. While our FY27 estimates are largely unchanged, we raise our FY29-31 NMV estimates by 7-18 per cent, with a similar increase in contribution profit estimates and a 20-40 per cent increase in EBITDA estimates. Meesho historically targeted a 2.5 per cent margin on logistics, but this had to be reinvested from mid-FY26 due to disruption in the logistics space and an increase in costs per parcel. However, logistics costs have started inching down (₹44 in Q3-FY26 to ₹42 in Q1-FY27), and management expects the sequential decline to continue, allowing Meesho to rebuild its logistics margin from 1.5-2.5 per cent over the next 2-3 quarters. Higher NMV forecasts reflect the continued flywheel from sellers (+81 per cent y-o-y to 1.04 million in Q1FY27), buyers (+29 per cent y-o-y to 274 million), coupled with rapid expansion in SKUs and logistics partners. The larger increase in EBITDA reflects a stronger medium-term margin trajectory, driven by improving ads monetisation and logistics economics. Management remains confident in the FY27 growth outlook. Although the shift in Diwali from Oct 2025 to Nov 2026 should result in slower growth in Q2 and faster growth in Q3, low-30s NMV growth remains achievable for FY27. We value Meesho using a combination of DCF and multiples. On the multiples approach, we apply a 40x EV/EBITDA multiple (unchanged) on 3YF EBITDA ie average of FY30-31 and discount it back by two years, deriving a PT of ₹260.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

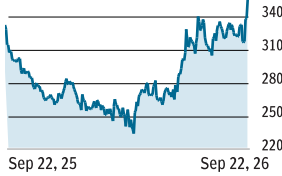
TODAY'S PICK.

JSW Infrastructure (₹367.85): BUY

Gurumurthy K bl. research bureau

JSW Infrastructure

Return 9% ₹ 367



The short-term outlook is bullish for JSW Infrastructure. The stock has surged over 5 per cent on Tuesday and has closed on a strong note.

This rise has taken the share price well above a key resistance level of ₹355. It also marks the end of the three-month long consolidation.

The region between ₹360 and ₹350 will now act as a good support and limit the downside. JSW Infrastructure share price can rise to ₹400-410 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy JSW Infrastructure shares now at ₹368.

Accumulate on dips at ₹360. Keep the stop-loss at ₹345

initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹376 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹383. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹385 and ₹393 when the price touches ₹392 and ₹399 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹405. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23409 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23340	23280	23480	23600	Go long now and at 23370. Keep the stop-loss at 23320

₹741 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
739	734	745	749	Take fresh shorts below 739. Keep the stop-loss at 741

₹1027 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1019	1000	1040	1050	Wait for a rise. Go short at 1037 with a stop-loss at 1045

₹265 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
263	259	266	269	Go short only below 263. Stop-loss can be kept at 264

₹235 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
234	231	236	239	Go short only below 234. Stop-loss can be placed at 235

₹1244 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1230	1200	1255	1275	Take fresh longs above 1255. Keep the stop-loss at 1245

₹986 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
980	968	993	1005	Go short only below 980. Stop-loss can be kept at 982

₹2104 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2100	2070	2135	2160	Go short on a break below 2100. Keep the stop-loss at 2105

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 85.30 pts.					
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)	
Eternal Ltd.	342.00	9.64	762.22	2.32	
Coal India	428.00	6.96	8.46	0.96	
Titan	4928.50	4.83	75.96	1.91	
Int'lGlobeAvi	5030.00	4.40	0.00	1.07	
Tata Steel	184.97	2.84	20.50	1.43	
Dr Reddys Lab	1221.00	1.69	31.75	0.69	
NTPC	2448.50	1.45	11.22	1.46	
Adani Enter	2987.00	1.39	51.90	0.81	
Adani Ports	1795.00	1.27	31.52	1.24	
Maruti Suzuki	12190.00	1.05	26.74	1.49	
Wipro	166.00	0.86	12.38	0.42	
Asian Paints	2448.50	0.81	48.55	1.04	
Apollo Hosp	1237.00	0.52	73.72	0.71	
ONGC	236.13	0.42	6.63	0.86	
SBI Life	1756.30	0.03	67.74	0.74	
HDFC Life	559.20	-0.05	61.10	0.56	
PowerGrid Corp	265.95	-0.15	15.56	1.13	
Cipla	1384.10	-0.25	33.32	0.73	
JSW Steel	1257.00	-0.33	11.07	1.11	
Bharat Elec	397.90	-0.47	47.31	1.33	
Tata Motors PV	300.05	-0.73	0.00	0.59	
Tech Mahindra	1551.60	-0.96	29.45	0.92	
Max Healthcare	1056.50	-1.64	70.55	0.74	
Apollis Hosp	8635.50	-2.44	19.77	1.25	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1006.06	-1.77	20.91	1.32	
M&M	3044.50	-2.11	18.70	2.55	
Bajaj Auto	11363.00	-2.35	27.49	1.18	
TataConsumerProduct	984.10	-2.35	59.30	0.60	
Trent Ltd.	2782.90	-2.37	81.78	0.87	
HCL Tech	12370.40	-2.44	19.77	1.25	
ITC	265.80	-2.53	16.50	2.40	
Hind Unilever	1933.80	-2.56	43.30	1.61	
Eicher Motors	7427.00	-2.57	35.32	0.96	
Hindalco	973.00	-2.59	13.33	1.32	
UltraTech Cement	11080.00	-2.59	37.82	1.22	
HDFC Bank	728.60	-3.01	13.79	10.59	
Grasim Ind	3128.20	-3.12	18.71	1.11	
NestleIndia	1363.90	-3.31	69.01	0.92	
Bajaj Finserv	1823.40	-3.34	14.14	0.99	
Kotak Bank	412.65	-3.46	20.22	2.85	
Axis Bank	1242.70	-4.58	13.83	3.34	
Sun Pharma	1846.40	-5.21	36.56	1.83	
TCS	2105.00	-5.29	15.22	2.01	
Infosys	1029.40	-6.97	13.77	3.38	
Bajaj Finance	1008.80	-7.32	30.42	2.53	
State Bank	313.60	-8.13	7.94	1.22	
ICI Bank	1339.60	-8.45	16.08	8.99	
Bharti Airtel	1817.20	-8.64	30.41	5.18	
L&T	3866.40	-9.82	27.11	4.24	
Reliance Ind	1240.40	-10.33	19.04	7.85	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▼ 279.90 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)	
Solar Industries	19890.00	44.24	87.78	1.96	
Varun Beverages	430.00	19.87	42.66	2.38	
Bosch	48290.00	18.28	60.27	1.70	
Oil	659.20	17.24	37.28	1.74	
Indian Oilcorp	137.80	13.79	5.45	2.08	
Vedanta	263.00	12.32	6.16	1.81	
Jindal Steel	1141.00	11.20	42.97	1.71	
Godrej Consumer	873.60	7.12	66.71	1.42	
Siemens Energy India	3235.00	5.22	77.42	1.16	
Adani Power	60.00	5.01	29.94	2.57	
Adani Power	206.96	4.94	27.46	3.48	
Macrotech Developers	1144.00	4.84	27.68	1.28	
Power Finance	345.80	4.44	3.39	2.04	
Bank Of Baroda	234.35	3.83	6.59	1.76	
ZydusIntelligence	1162.30	3.95	25.47	1.18	
United Spirits	1398.00	0.96	60.07	1.67	
Adani Greenenergy	0.39	0.95	100.69	1.77	
Pidilite	1572.70	-0.45	59.81	1.97	
Union Bank	178.00	-0.51	6.58	1.39	
Tata Power	367.00	-0.73	22.31	2.48	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	80.00	-1.29	14.54	0.65	
Hindus Zinc	590.50	-1.82	14.62	1.15	
Tata Capital	941.10	-3.80	26.43	0.69	
Indus Towers	244.00	-5.32	25.34	2.84	
Gail (India)	171.84	-0.64	11.45	1.88	
Cholamandilam&Fin	1759.10	-6.16	26.08	3.08	
Mazagon Dock	2204.00	-6.18	31.15	0.68	
Ambuja Cements	386.90	-6.98	18.54	0.98	
Muthootfin	2831.50	-7.07	9.92	1.23	
Siemens	3858.00	-7.45	94.57	1.38	
Canak Bank	122.00	-7.81	5.62	1.67	
Punjab Natl Bank	117.00	-10.01	6.08	1.63	
Yates Motor Comp.	410.00	-10.24	54.62	3.94	
Avensuspiper	3777.00	-10.96	80.57	2.46	
Rural Elec	30.10	-11.25	5.04	1.55	
Sree Cement	22200.00	-13.60	48.96	1.20	
HindustanAeronautics	4900.00	14.23	34.44	3.69	
SamvardhanaInvestmentPvt	44.00	14.64	37.48	0.68	
Torrent Pharma	4835.00	-14.92	87.06	2.93	
Adani Energy Solutions	1381.70	-15.17	53.71	1.84	
Hyundai Motor India	210.00	-17.82	34.48	1.21	
Divis Lab	9352.00	-21.61	84.88	4.81	
Indian Hotels Co.	736.25	-22.63	45.39	2.62	
Ab In India	7120.50	-22.95	97.02	1.51	
Industries Cv	40.00	-26.71	34.81	3.72	
Cp Power & Ind Sol	896.10	-27.70	113.99	2.49	
Bajaj Holdings	11185.00	-28.18	13.84	1.94	
Limtintree	4158.30	-32.85	23.74	1.56	
Britannia Ind	4918.00	-35.94	45.38	2.34	
Cummins India	4962.50	-41.02	58.11	2.71	



Mangaluru – A Coastal Hub of Prosperity

With a history spanning over a thousand years, the coastal city of Mangaluru stands as one of Karnataka's most prominent cities on the global map. Located at the confluence of the Netravathi and Phalguni rivers, the city has leveraged its sheltered yet proximate location to the Arabian Sea since antiquity. Consequently, it has maintained a preeminent position as a center of trade and commerce. Agriculture and sea-based trade were the region's chief economic activities. From the sixteenth century onwards, the region came under European influence with the gradual rise of colonial activity. The advent of the Basel Mission in 1834 marked a significant step towards the region's education and industrialization. The missionaries established schools, printing presses, textile mills, and factories that produced Mangalore tiles. This educational awakening motivated many local community leaders to champion the cause of learning, enabling the region to become educationally advanced.

The innate entrepreneurial spirit of the people flourished, resulting in the rise of traditional industries such as clay tile and brick making, cashew nut processing, beedi production, and banking. These industries utilized the abundant natural resources and the inherent talent of the local people. The beedi industry, for example, organized itself into



an unimaginably large and complex home industry, serving as a catalyst for the economic and social upliftment of a significant segment of the rural populace. It particularly empowered women by providing income-earning opportunities. The financial acumen of the people led to the emergence of modern banking, earning the region the sobriquet "the cradle of banking," as it has given birth to many large banking institutions. Canara Bank, one of the largest public sector banks in the country, was established here. Additionally, three major banks—Corporation Bank, Syndicate Bank, and Vijaya Bank—were recently merged with other public sector banks, while Karnataka Bank remains a prominent private bank based in Mangaluru.

On May 23, 1866, a municipal council for Mangaluru was mandated by the Madras Town Improvement Act

(1865) to oversee civic amenities and urban planning. The Italian Jesuits who arrived in the city in 1878 played an important role in the city's education, economy, health, and social welfare. Mangaluru was connected to the Southern Railway in 1907, and the subsequent proliferation of motor vehicles in India further increased trade and communication between the city and the rest of the country. By the early 20th century, Mangaluru was a major source of educated workers for Bombay, Bangalore, and the Middle East. The region was among the first to capitalize on the invention of the automobile, and some of the earliest public transport companies were established here.

Today, the city boasts one of the most well-organized and efficient privately owned public transport networks in Karnataka.

SKF ELIXER: Engineering Sustainable Solutions From Pure Drinking Water to Wastewater Management

Access to safe drinking water is a basic necessity, yet for many communities, institutions and workplaces, obtaining reliable drinking water continues to be a challenge. In many places, people have traditionally depended on packaged drinking water, particularly when travelling or in locations where a dependable drinking water



source is not readily available. Apart from the recurring cost, the growing use of single-use plastic bottles has added another environmental concern.

It is against this backdrop that **SKF Elixer India Pvt. Ltd.** has developed a range of drinking-water purification systems designed to provide a more convenient and sustainable alternative. The company's water plants are built to serve different requirements — from individual homes and offices to schools, hospitals, places of worship, commercial establishments and larger public spaces.

The idea is simple: instead of people having to depend on packaged bottles wherever safe drinking water is unavailable, purified drinking water can be made available at the point of need.

SKF Elixer's range includes **Domestic, Institutional, Corporate and Commercial drinking-water plants**, as well as **Public**

drinking-water filling counters and **Rural filling counters**. Depending on the application, the systems can provide plain, hot and cold drinking water, allowing organisations to select a solution suited to their requirements.

The community applications are particularly significant in areas where access to safe drinking water remains limited. The company's rural filling counters, for instance, can have a capacity of **5,000 litres a day**. A system of this scale can potentially serve around **250 families** in a village, depending on daily consumption. Such decentralised solutions can reduce the need for residents to travel long distances for drinking water and can offer an alternative to purchasing water in plastic containers.

The systems have also been adopted by schools, hospitals, places of worship, offices and other institutions looking to provide drinking water for employees, visitors, students and the wider public. Companies and organisations have also sup-



ported such installations as part of their **CSR initiatives**, while public representatives and institutions have contributed systems to locations where they can benefit larger groups of people.

The significance of such infrastructure extends beyond convenience. Providing purified water closer to where people live, study, work and gather can contribute to better access to safe

drinking water while reducing dependence on packaged water and the associated plastic waste.

Beyond Drinking Water: Treating What We Use

Water sustainability does not end with providing safe drinking water. With growing urbanisation and increasing pressure on freshwater resources, treating and re-using wastewater is becoming an essential part of responsible water management.

SKF Elixer addresses this need through its SKF Vulcan STP, a compact stainless-steel sewage treatment plant designed to treat wastewater generated from kitchens, toilets and other domestic sources. The treated water can then be reused for suitable non-potable applications such as toilet flushing, gardening and firefighting, reducing the demand for fresh water.

Designed with a plug-and-play approach and requiring

minimal maintenance, the SKF Vulcan STP can be deployed in apartments, residential layouts, institutions, commercial establishments and industrial premises. Its stainless-steel construction provides a durable and practical solution for on-site wastewater treatment.

The principle is straightforward: wastewater need not always be treated as waste. With the right technology, it can become a resource that supports everyday requirements while reducing the pressure on freshwater supplies.

SKF Elixer has taken its wastewater-treatment solutions beyond the domestic market as well, with its systems finding applications in international markets. Through solutions such as the SKF Vulcan STP, the company aims to contribute to a more sustainable approach to water use — treating, recovering and reusing water wherever possible.



Wherever pure drinking water is needed... ELIXER

RO UV TDS
CONTROL
TECHNOLOGY

MINERAL WATER PLANTS



RURAL FILLING COUNTERS

Usage:
For rural drinking water projects

Capacity:
500 LPH & 1000 LPH

Special Feature:
Each unit provides 20 litres of pure drinking water daily to approximately 250 families



PUBLIC FILLING COUNTERS

Usage:
For temples, bus stands, railway stations, airports, and public places

Capacity:
500 LPH & 1000 LPH

Output:
PLAIN



INSTITUTIONAL PLANTS

Usage:
For offices, hospitals, educational institutions, and other organizations

Capacity:
15 LPH to 100 LPH

Output:
HOT | COLD | PLAIN

COMMERCIAL PLANTS

Usage:
For hotels, restaurants, bakeries, catering services, marriage halls, and food processing industries

Capacity:
25 LPH to 1000 LPH

Output:
PLAIN



CORPORATE PLANTS

Usage:
For offices and small workplaces with up to 20 staff members

Capacity:
15 LPH & 60 LPH

Output:
HOT | PLAIN



DOMESTIC PLANTS

Usage:
Ultra-modern RO water purifier for homes

Capacity:
10 litres storage

Output:
HOT | COLD | PLAIN



WASTE WATER MANAGEMENT SOLUTIONS

SKF
VULCAN STP

Applications: STP solutions for schools, colleges, hospitals, hotels, homestays, apartments, gated communities, industries and all types of projects.

Process & Use: Processes waste water from toilets, bathrooms and kitchens into treated water for suitable reuse in toilet flushing, gardening, fire safety systems and cooling towers.



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QUICKLY.

Gold slips as Fed officials signal rate hikes



Gold prices eased on Tuesday as hawkish signals from US Fed policymakers reinforced market expectations that interest rates will stay higher for longer. Spot gold was down 0.5 per cent at \$4,321.74 per ounce by 1213 GMT. US gold futures fell 0.6 per cent to \$4,359.20. Silver fell 0.7 per cent to \$65.57. REUTERS

Copper gains for sixth session on Chinese buying

London: Copper prices extended gains for a sixth session on Tuesday as top metals consumer China stocked up ahead of holidays. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME rose 0.7 per cent to \$14,758 a tonne. LME copper has climbed 18 per cent so far this year. Nickel gained 1.3 per cent to \$16,530 and tin was little changed at \$53,950. REUTERS

Cocoa rebounds from multi-week lows



London: Cocoa futures recovered after setting 7-1/2-week lows earlier in the session. London cocoa rose 2.6 per cent to £4,060 a tonne by 1323 GMT. New York cocoa gained 2.3 per cent to \$5,476. Raw sugar rose 0.6 per cent to 17.58 cents per lb after setting a month-low of 17.11 cents. White sugar fell 0.1 per cent to \$507 a tonne. REUTERS

EU finds genetically modified organisms in five Chinese products this year

GMO CONCERNS. The development comes even as China rejected Indian rice shipments since March on the same charge

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

The European Union has found genetically modified organisms (GMOs) in at least five rice cracker, noodles or flour consignments from China this year, according to notifications issued by the EU's Rapid Alert System for Food and Feed (RASFF). The development comes at a time when China has rejected shipments of Indian rice for the alleged presence of GMOs since March this year. Besides, it has turned away consignments from Kazakhstan, Russia, Ukraine, Belarus and Japan, which ban the cultivation of GMO crops. These countries were alleged to have shipped rape-seed oil and wheat flour. Data show that China has rejected a record 146 shipments between January and

June, nearly four times the 38 rejections in 2025.

S TERMINATOR According to RASFF notifications, the presence of GMOs has been found in rice sticks, crackers, noodles and hydrolysed rice flour. Besides, GMO was found in Miso paste, a traditional Japanese seasoning made from fermented soybeans, salt and a fungus called *kofu*. The EU gave out alerts on GMO presence on March 12, July 6 and 12, August 3 and September 8. In the latest reported case, Italian authorities found "unauthorised GMO 35 S terminator in rice sticks". The S terminator is a specific DNA sequence derived from the soil bacterium *Agrobacterium tumefaciens* that signals the end of gene transcription in genetically modified organisms. Scientists use it when engineering



WHEN THE BOOT IS...The EU food safety regulator said the presence of GMOs has been found in rice sticks, crackers, noodles and hydrolysed rice flour from China

transgenic plants. It works with a promoter to help plant cells properly express inserted genes. On August 3, Italy reported GMO presence in rice crackers from China, while the Netherlands said it

detected GMOs in China's hydrolysed rice flour consignments on July 6. **JUST 1 FROM INDIA** In the Miso paste from China, the Netherlands' au-

Mills sold only 7 lakh tonnes of sugar at ₹50/kg in Aug

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The pan-India average ex-mill sugar price is currently hovering around ₹4,450 per quintal, which is nearly 30 per cent lower from its peak level, said the Indian Sugar & Bio-energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA) and the National Federation of Co-operative Sugar Factories (NFCSF) in a joint statement. In light of the recent favourable movement in sugar prices across the value chain, retail prices have also witnessed a correction, declin-

ing by around 11-12 per cent across the country to approximately ₹57.5 per kg, the industry associations said on Tuesday. The retail prices (as of September 21) in the top producing States were recorded even less than the national average, they said, adding in Uttar Pradesh it was ₹55.09/kg, Maharashtra ₹56.74/kg, Karnataka ₹56.19/kg and Tamil Nadu ₹57.45/kg. "This positive price movement reflects the combined impact of market dynamics and the government's continued efforts to maintain a balanced sugar ecosystem

supported by the industry, ensuring adequate availability, and safeguarding the interests of consumers and other stakeholders," the statement said. **NO WINDFALL GAINS** Denying that sugar mills had reaped windfall gains from the recent increase in prices, the industry bodies said that ex-mill values corrected rapidly and the vast majority of the nation's annual supply was dispatched at substantially lower price levels. "Review of dispatch volumes reveal that the recent price surge was strictly temporary and confined to a

The pan-India average ex-mill sugar price is currently about 30 per cent lower from its peak level of around ₹4,450 per quintal very narrow window. Between August 17 and August 31, sugar mills across India sold only about 7.22 lakh tonnes (lt) at an average ex-mill price of ₹4,996.98 per quintal. When measured against the country's total annual domestic consump-

tion of approximately 285 lt, this volume accounts for less than 2.5 per cent of overall annual sales. Consequently, over 97.5 per cent of the domestic requirement has been marketed at normal or subdued price levels, dispelling any notion that the mill sector derived excessive profits from the momentary peak, and highlighting the industry's role in providing steady, reasonably priced supplies to the market," said ISMA and NFCSF. **DUES CLEARED** Further, they also said that in the current sugar season since it began from October

2025 till mid-September, the weighted pan-India average ex-mill realisation stands at around ₹4,100 per quintal (₹41 per kg). This seasonal average remains significantly depressed in relation to actual operational expenditures, particularly when evaluated against statutory input costs and conversion costs. During the 2025-26 season, sugar mills have already cleared about ₹1.12 lakh crore to sugarcane farmers for buying the crop, accounting for over 97 per cent of the total cane payments due, reflecting the industry's continued commitment to timely payments to farmers.

TRADE STRATEGY Technically, it is ideal for traders to wait for the break of the ₹342-360 range. However, traders with higher risk appetite can consider buying aluminium futures if the price dips to ₹343. Place the initial stop-loss at ₹340. When the contract rises to ₹355, revise the stop-loss to ₹350. Book profits at ₹359.

Sugar alone is not viable, focus on byproducts, Gadkari tells co-operatives

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Pointing out that sugar alone is not viable since its prices is determined in Brazil, Road Transport Minister Nitin Gadkari on Tuesday asked cooperative mills to focus on byproducts for the energy sector, where there are unlimited opportunities. He said that using bagasse for cogen power at the current rate is not viable as the fibrous residue of sugarcane could be better utilised to produce CBG, which the government has committed to buy at a remunerative price. Addressing the annual award event of the National Federation of Cooperative Sugar Factories (NFCSF) in New Delhi on Tuesday, Gadkari appealed to the industry to focus on recovery improvement as 1 per cent additional recovery would



Nitin Gadkari, Minister for Road Transport & Highways

translate into an additional between ₹50,000 crore and ₹60,000 crore a year. "If there will be economic viability through these byproducts, you (mills) will be able to pay ₹600/quintal to sugarcane farmers," he said, appealing to the cooperative leaders to expand into developing more and more byproducts from sugarcane.

TOYOTA'S PLANS The Minister told the audi-

ence that Toyota Motors had requested him to launch its first Innova flex fuel SUV in October, which will run on 100 per cent ethanol and also generate electricity, again to be utilised in running the vehicle, lowering the cost. He asked the NFCSF leaders to realise that the entire system is urban-centric as a small increase in prices of agriculture produce is highlighted by the media as a major issue whereas they ignore when farmers throw onion or tomato on the roads on prices dropping below ₹1/kg. "Right now, when the price of onions drops to 50 paise, farmers throw their produce away. Yet, there is no news coverage about it on TV — hardly any reports on how many people discarded their tomatoes or onions. But when the price hits ₹50 per kg, our politicians go around wearing protest garlands. All day long, the refrain is

onions have become expensive. This is because the entire system is urban-centric." Gadkari suggested that to break free from this situation, the first step is to utilise technology. Citing the example of Brazil and its large land holdings — a single farm spans over 2,000-3,000 acres, he said production cost for sugar there comes to ₹23 per kg, whereas in India it is at least ₹33-34. "That is why, if Brazil has a sugar surplus, prices in India drop. Conversely, if Brazil faces a shortage, prices here rise. And why do they rise? Not because of our factories, but because of the situation in Brazil. After all, Brazil is the world's largest exporter of sugar," he said. On reviving closed sugar mills, Gadkari said it is time to continue growing sugarcane and develop projects to convert sugarcane juice directly into ethanol.

Crude oil at 2-week low on improved supplies

Reuters
London

Crude oil prices fell to a two-week low as prospects for Gulf supplies improved, with Iran signalling it could reopen the Strait of Hormuz within seven days and Saudi Arabia set to resume exports from its Red Sea port of Yanbu. The Brent crude futures November contract was down \$2.11 to \$98.23 a barrel at 1151 GMT. The WTI October contract, which expires on Tuesday, lost \$2.48 to \$93.30. Brent November, WTI October and WTI November futures all touched their lowest levels since September 8. Market focus is also on US President Donald Trump's meetings with world leaders at the UN General Assembly this week.

FreshTerra takes a different route to source farmers' produce

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Omnichannel food convenience firm FreshTerra, which recently opened its first store in Gurugram in addition to its online platform, has taken a different route to source its products from farmers: Making advance payments and guaranteeing them a minimum order value. "They don't have to worry about getting money. We are making advance payments to farmers. We are guaranteeing them a certain minimum order value over the next 5-6 months. They look forward to a certain minimum volume commitment. So we have been able to do that," said Arvind Mediratta, the firm's Founder. Procurement from farm-



Arvind Mediratta, Founder, FreshTerra

quality team, which goes and checks every supplier's facility before certifying that the firm can buy from them. "Where we are doing contract manufacturing, again, our team is present when the product is being manufactured and being put into the pack. So we are maintaining strict quality control," he said.

MORE BIZ WITH FPOs The company has rejected products from multinational suppliers, some of them big, on the grounds of quality. "For example, we tested chocolates. We found palm oil in them. Similarly, we rejected 2-3 big factories of well-known brands for organic because we were not happy with the overall conditions in the factories," he said.

Depression in Bay intensifies, eyes AP-Odisha coast

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

Monday's depression over the west-central and adjoining north-west Bay of Bengal is closing in on the north Andhra Pradesh-south Odisha coast for landfall, with the India Meteorological Department (IMD) expecting it to intensify into a deep depression, one rung below a cyclone, by Tuesday midnight or early Wednesday. The system was located about 180 km south-south-east of Gopalpur, 180 km east-southeast of Kalingapatnam, 210 km south of Puri and 270 km east of Visakhapatnam, the IMD said in an update on Tuesday evening. It is expected to move west-north-west, intensify further and cross the coast between Visakhapatnam

and Gopalpur by Wednesday night, retaining deep-depression strength at landfall. This happens as the prevailing monsoon exits from the north-west, creating a sharp contrast between a season winding down over land and a late-season system gathering strength over the Bay. **WITHDRAWAL PAUSE** The advancing withdrawal line was positioned on Tuesday along Jaisalmer-Nagaur-Sikar-Rohtak-Patiala-Gurda- spur extending from Rajasthan into Punjab, Chandigarh and Delhi. The IMD said the conditions remained favourable for it to advance further over the next two days into the remaining parts of these areas and into Saurashtra, Kutch, Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and west Uttar

Pradesh. But the Bay depression could temporarily stall the monsoon withdrawal as its circulation pumps moisture deep into the peninsula and Central India. While the monsoon retreats from the country's north-western flank, its late-season circulation could still generate a fresh spell of widespread rain far inland. **ODISHA IN FOCUS** South Odisha is expected to bear the brunt initially, with heavy to very heavy and isolated extremely heavy rain for another two days. Heavy to very heavy rain is forecast on Friday, followed by heavy rain on Saturday. Farther north, the remnants of the system could interact with a resident western disturbance, potentially creating another heavy rain belt extending through Ch-

hattisgarh, east Madhya Pradesh and south-west and east Uttar Pradesh before crossing into Nepal over the weekend. **WESTERN DISTURBANCE** The European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts also pointed to north Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and parts of Odisha and West Bengal as areas vulnerable to heavy rain. A second potential rain zone could emerge around Lucknow, Faizabad, Sitapur, and Bahraich in Uttar Pradesh, extending towards the Himalayan foothills and into Nepal. Heavy rain is indicated at several locations stretching from the Andhra Pradesh coast through Odisha and West Bengal into Central India and the eastern flanks of parts of North-West India.

TECHNOPARK

INVITES PROPOSALS THROUGH RFP FOR SELECTION OF
A CO-DEVELOPER TO BUILD & OPERATE AN IT BUILDING UNDER THE QUAD PROJECT
Technopark Phase IV (Technology), Thiruvananthapuram (RFP No. 185/2026)

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KEY DATES

PRE-BID MEETING
12 October 2026
11:00 AM

LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF PROPOSAL
12 November 2026
Upto 5:00 PM

CLARIFICATIONS & QUERIES
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TATA POWER

(Corporate Contracts Department)

Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173188) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Tata Power Company Limited hereby invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from eligible bidders for participation in following tender:
"Sale of Fly Ash from Trombay Thermal Power Station, Mumbai"
(Tender Ref: TPCL/CC/FY27/DK15)

For details of Tender scope, Pre-qualification requirements, process of participation in tender, tender fee and bid security etc., please visit Tender section of our website (URL: <https://www.tatapower.com/tender>) and refer detailed Tender Notice. Eligible bidders willing to participate in tender may submit their Expression of Interest along with the tender fee latest by **3rd October 2026**. Future corrigendum's (if any), to the above tenders will be published on Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com/tender> only.

TATA POWER

(Corporate Contracts Department)

The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 2nd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road, Andheri East, Mumbai-400059
(Board Line: 022-67173188) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The Tata Power Company Limited invites tenders from eligible vendors for the following package (Two Part Bidding).
1) 4100071381/CC27AD0011 – Supply of Truck/Trolley mounted Mobile Battery Energy Storage System (BESS).
Last date for Bid Submission: 7th October 2026, 3:00 PM
For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Also, all future corrigendum's if any, to the said tender to the said tender will be informed on Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com> only.

MAITHON POWER LIMITED

(Contracts Department)

Maithon Power Ltd, Village: Dambhui, PO Barbindia, PIN-828205, District-Dhanbad

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Maithon Power Limited, a joint venture between Tata Power and DVC invites expression of interest from eligible vendors for the following packages:

S.No.	Ref.No	Package Description
1	1000080918	Supply of FUEL, AGRO-BASED BIOMASS PELLETS at MPL
2	1500021707	Supply PAIR OF MATING BEVEL WHEELS FOR KMP300
3	3000011000	supply, commissioning of PDF remote operation using wireless technology.

For details of pre-qualification requirements, bid security, purchasing of tender document etc., please visit our website URL- <https://www.tatapower.com/tender>. Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee for issue of bid document latest by **01st October, 2026**

TRAI mandates wider array of voice and SMS only plans

PRICE HACK. Aims to give low-income, non-data users more affordable recharge options

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Indians will soon enjoy a wider selection of voice and SMS only tariff plans after the telecom regulator directed operators to introduce more such offerings with validity periods of 30 days and beyond.

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) has mandated the availability of shorter-duration tariff plans of up to 30 days, with charges proportionate to the validity period, under the Telecom Consumer Protection (Thirteenth Amendment) Regulations, 2026.

It also directed operators to offer at least one voice and SMS only plan with validity



Operators must ensure that these packs can be renewed on the same date every month

exceeding 30 days, with charges aligned to the duration of the pack.

Operators must ensure that the validity of these packs can be renewed on the same date every month.

If that date does not exist in a particular month, the renewal date shall fall on the

last day of that month. The regulator noted the limited availability of voice and SMS only plans currently offered by telecom service providers, stating that most such packs are concentrated in longer-validity segments, thereby restricting affordable short-duration options for low-income consumers.

SUBSIDISE PLANS
Mahesh Uppal, Director at Com First (India), said, "People with small budgets deserve this choice. The success of mobile services is often linked to small and micro recharges. There is no reason why people should be tied to long-term plans, especially since TRAI does not regulate the actual amount. The companies should not be asked to

subsidise these plans because that will distort the market." Currently, Jio offers an annual and quarterly plans of ₹1,748 and ₹448 respectively. Vodafone Idea offers ₹1,849 annually and ₹470 quarterly plans. Airtel offers ₹1,849 and ₹469 annual and quarterly plans.

However, an operator cautioned that shorter-duration plans could aid spammers by making it harder for authorities and telecom companies to identify and track numbers used for unsolicited messages.

During an earlier open-house discussion, the company argued that the frequent churn of SIMs under shorter-validity packs could complicate spam detection efforts.

Bank unions to go ahead with three-day strike from Sept 28

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU) has decided to press ahead with its three-day strike beginning Septem-

ber 28 as there was no resolution to its demand for implementation of five-day banking at the conciliation meeting on Tuesday at the office of the Deputy Chief Labour Commissioner, Ministry of Labour.

Besides UFBU office-bearers, representatives from the Indian Banks' Association, Department of Financial Services and bank managements were present at the meeting in New Delhi. "We pointed out that there is no

response to our demand for implementation of five-day banking, which was agreed to and signed in March 2024 under the last wage revision settlement. Hence, we are going ahead with the strike action," said UFBU.

GOLDEN MOMENT



TWICE AS SWEET. Harmanpreet Kaur and team retained the gold medal at the 2026 Asian Games, defeating Sri Lanka by 147 runs in the women's cricket final, in Nagoya, Japan, on Tuesday

‘Financial, operational scrutiny of SpiceJet aimed at ensuring safety’

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The aviation safety regulator is undertaking operational as well as financial scrutiny of SpiceJet amid the airline's financial difficulties, Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu said on Tuesday.

According to Naidu, the scrutiny through the Directorate General of Civil Aviation is aimed at ensuring that safety is not compromised.

"We do not want any lapse in safety," he said, responding to a question on the air-

line's financial position and pending funding under the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS).

GOVT INTERVENTION
"For the future, we are continuously engaging with the airline and examining how best the Ministry can facilitate matters. But these are private airlines, and there are limits to what the government can do," he said.

"Our main priority is to ensure that passengers do not face inconvenience, that safety is not compromised at any cost, and that smooth

operations are sustained," Naidu said.

Besides, Naidu said SpiceJet had received ₹150 crore under the ECLGS, while the remaining funding has to be worked out between the airline and its bank.

Asked about the disbursement of a further ₹350 crore, the Minister said, "The remaining amount is something the organisation and the bank have to work out. The scheme is in place; they need to obtain the funds," Naidu said.

The Minister did not indicate a timeline for further disbursement.

Fredun Pharma buys 26% stake in Goodman Vetcare Pvt Ltd

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Fredun Pharmaceuticals Limited has acquired a 26 per cent stake in Goodman Vetcare Private Limited for an undisclosed sum.

This is Fredun Pharma's second acquisition in the animal health and veterinary retail and pet care market in less than two weeks.

The acquisition gives Fredun Pharma a foothold into Goodman's established retail network. Earlier this month, it acquired USV's pet-wellness brand Furlicks for an undisclosed sum.

Fredun Pharma said that Goodman had grown its revenue by 30 per cent annually from ₹14.1 crore in FY24 to ₹23.6 crore in FY26, without a push from venture capital. The brand is targeting ₹40 crore in revenue by FY27 and ₹56 crore by FY28.

The plan is to take the brand across India with at least eight new stores across three cities, targeting revenue of ₹100 crore in revenue by FY31, Fredun Pharma said.

In FY26, the company reported profit after tax of ₹33.21 crore.



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